

Markmap_314Codebase

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JOURNAL314 – Concept Map (Theme – Figure – Quote)

Existential Dread

A. W. Tozer

- Our woes began when God was forced out of His central shrine and "things" were allowed to enter. Within the human heart "things" have takenâ€
- Let him insist that God accept his all, that He take things out of his heart and Himself reign there in power. It may be he will need to beâ€
- The world is perishing for lack of the knowledge of God and the Church is famishing for want of His Presence. The instant cure of most of oâ€
- ...the rending of the veil...is nothing pleasant...To tear it away is to injure us, to hurt us and make us bleed. To say otherwise is to maâ€
- This universal Voice has ever sounded, and it has often troubled men even when they did not understand the source of their fears. Could it â€
- Over against these sacred acts are the secular ones. They include all of the ordinary activities of life...The upshot of this is that we arâ€

Albert Camus

- Yet a day comes when a man notices or says that he is thirty. Thus he asserts his youth. But simultaneously he situates himself in relationâ€
- Kierkegaard may shout in warning: "If man had no eternal consciousness, if, at the bottom of everything, there were merely a wild, seethingâ€
- (Kafka) His work is universal (a really absurd work is not universal) to the extent to which it represents the emotionally moving face of aâ€
- one must, like the donkey, feed on the roses of illusion, then the absurd mind, rather than resigning itself to falsehood, prefers to adoptâ€

Aldous Huxley

- It was inexpressibly wonderful, wonderful to the point, almost, of being terrifying. And suddenly I had an inkling of what it must feel likâ€
- Alas, this paradise of cleansed perception, of pure one-sided contemplation, was not to endure. The blissful intermissions became rarer, beâ€

- ...I found myself all at once on the brink of panic. This, I suddenly felt, was going too far. Too far, even though the going was into it!
- No I couldn't control it. If one began with fear and hate as the major premise, one would have to go on to the conclusion.
- Verbalists are suspicious of the non-verbal; rationalists fear the given, non-rational fact; intellectuals feel that "what we perceive by it"
- Near the end of his life Aquinas experienced Infused Contemplation. Thereafter he refused to go back to work on his unfinished book. Compare!

Angela of Foligno

- "Blessed (saith He), verily blessed is, and shall be, he who loveth poverty in all the aforesaid things and who desireth to be truly poor in it"
- In that time and by God's will there died my mother, who was a great hindrance unto me in following the way of God; my husband died likewise!

Augustine

- For there is an attractiveness in beautiful bodies, in gold and silver, and all things; and in bodily touch, sympathy hath much influence, it is!
- At this grief my heart was utterly darkened; and whatever I beheld was death.
- For I wondered that others, subject to death, did live, since he whom I loved, as if he should never die, was dead. and I wondered yet more!
- I panted after honours, gains, marriage; and thou mocked me. Let my soul cleave unto Thee, now that Thou hast freed it from that fast-stick!
- But having then read those books of the Platonists, and thence been taught to search for incorporeal truth, I saw Thy invisible things, undying!
- The storm tosses the voyagers, threatens shipwreck, and everyone turns pale in the presence of death.

Bertrand Russell

- And from the monsters, as the play unfolded itself, Man was born, with the power of thought, the knowledge of good and evil, and the cruel it is!
- Let us preserve our respect for truth, for beauty, for the ideal of perfection which life does not permit us to attain, though none of these!
- Yet, by death, by illness, by poverty, or by the voice of duty, we must learn, each one of us, that the world was not made for us, and that it is!
- Except for those rare spirits that are born without sin, there is a cavern of darkness to be traversed before that temple can be entered. That is!
- In the spectacle of Death, in the endurance of intolerable pain, and in the irrevocableness of a vanished past, there is a sacredness, an oath!

- To take into the inmost shrine of the soul the irresistible forces whose puppets we seem to be—Death and change, the irrevocableness of the—

Buddhism

- We may not be happy to hear about our death, but contemplating and meditating on death is very important for the effectiveness of our Dharma
- All flesh submerged in the sea of sorrow; all diseases collected as the bubbling froth; decay and age like the wild billows; death like the—
- "This is a dead man: all his powers of body destroyed, life departed; his heart without thought, his intellect dispersed; his spirit gone, —"
- But Bodhisattva, peaceful and collected, firm as a rock, difficult to move, hearing all these women's talk, unaffected either to joy or sor—
- It is not that I am careless about beauty, or am ignorant of the power of human joys, but only that I see on all the impress of change; the—
- To know that other men grow old, sicken, and die, would be enough to rob such joys of satisfaction; yet how much more in their own case (know—

C. S. Lewis

- That is the terrible fix we are in. If the universe is not governed by an absolute goodness, then all our efforts are in the long run hopeless
- If H. — is not,—™ then she never was. I mistook a cloud of atoms for a person. There arenâ™t, and never were, any people. Death only reveals that—
- The agonies, the mad midnight moments, must, in the course of nature, die away. But what will follow? Just this apathy, this dead flatness?

Edgar Saltus

- He was not much over twenty before excessive study had well-nigh ruined such health as he once possessed. The slightest application was wear—
- The Buddhist believes that the soul migrates until Nirvāṇa is attained, and that in the preparation for this state, which is the death of Dâ—
- In the world ye shall have tribulation," is the explicit warning of the Founder of Christianity, and to this warning all creeds, save that —
- There are those, too, who from dyspepsia, torpidity of the liver, or general crankiness of disposition, are inclined to take a gloomy view —
- ...whatever their private beliefs may be, they still wish their neighbors to think that they at least have no cause to complain. It is this—
- Added to this, and beyond the insatiable desire to appear serene and successful in the eyes of others, there is the terrible dread of seemi—

Emile Cioran

- only a few can endure such experiences to the end. there is always a serious danger in repressing something which requires objectification,â€
- the vulgar interpretation of universality calls it a phenomenon of quantitative expansion rather than a qualitatively rich containment. sucâ€
- the experience of suffering is a similar case. you never suspected what lay hidden in yourself and in the world, you were living contentedlâ€
- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreaâ€
- at the edge of life everything is an occasion for death...every experience is in this case a leap into nothingness.
- did not all the mystics feel that they could not live after their great ecstasies? what could they expect from this world, those who sense,â€

Ernest Becker

- This narcissism is what keeps men marching into point-blank fire in wars: at heart one doesnâ€™t feel that he will die, he only feels sorry fâ€
- It doesnâ€™t matter whether the cultural hero-system is frankly magical, religious, and primitive or secular, scientific, and civilized. It iâ€
- Everything painful and sobering in what psychoanalytic genius and religious genius have discovered about man revolves around the terror of â€
- As Montaigne said, the peasant has a profound indifference and a patience toward death and the sinister side of life; and if we say that thâ€
- as the Eastern sages also knew, man is a worm and food for worms. This is the paradox: he is out of nature and hopelessly in it; he is dualâ€
- The knowledge of death is reflective and conceptual, and animals are spared it. They live and they disappear with the same thoughtlessness:â€

Evelyn Underhill

- In the great moments of existence, when he rises to spiritual freedom, these are the things which every man feels to be real. It is by thesâ€
- Those who are temperamentally inclined to credulity may become naturalists, and persuade themselves to believe in the reality of the sense â€
- The question is not, whence come those conditions which provoke in the self the experiences called sorrow, anxiety, pain: but, why do theseâ€
- Our bodies are animal things, made for animal activities. When a spirit of unusual ardour insists on using its nerve-cells for other activiâ€
- The mystic, too, tries very hard to tell an unwilling world his secret. But in his case, the difficulties are enormously increased. First, â€
- Here, in this world of illusion, they say, we have no continuing city. This statement, to you a proposition, is to us the central fact of lâ€

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- ...if God is dead, if there is no immortality- then this world is all there is, and this world is absurd, this world is Hell.
- In the Christian order all activity in this life is viewed and judged in the light of the life of the future world, the life beyond death wâ€™!
- If there is no immortality, the Liberal believes, one can still lead a civilized life; "if there is no immortality"-is the far profounder lâ€™!
- If he is not concerned to found the political and social order upon Divine Truth, if he is indifferent to the reality of Heaven and Hell, iâ€™!
- Who wishes to be creative," said Nietzsche, "Must first destroy and smash accepted values." (Nihiltheism says you must smash accepted valueâ€™!
- ...everywhere men feverishly pursue the work of "progress"--for what reason they do not know, or only very dimly sense. In the free world iâ€™!

GK Chesterton

- The new scientific society definitely discourages men from thinking about death; it is a fact, but it is considered a morbid fact.
- Take first the more obvious case of materialism. As an explanation of the world, materialism has a sort of insane simplicity. It has just tâ€™!
- Can he hate it enough to change it, and yet love it enough to think it worth changing? Can he look up at its colossal good without once feeâ€™!
- He can only get away from death by continually stepping within an inch of it...He must not merely cling to life, for then he will be a cowaâ€™!
- s argument; we have at once the sense of it covering everything and the sense of it leaving everything out...His cosmos may be complete in â€™!

Herman TÃ„nnessen

- ...cognitive...empathetic 'disintegrity'...to hold cognitively incompatible views or positions...to prevent knowledge from penetrating 'volâ€™!
- Ordinary language...it lulls us into this platitudinal world of small-talk where everything is taken for granted: life, death, the world, aâ€™!
- If a student has difficulties in getting to the university because of their fear of stepping on cracks in the pavement, this is not a problâ€™!
- ...most modern men against the terrifying insight into their conditions, is their safe and busy way of life, which pushes back from their câ€™!
- The question permeates him with dread and anguish, with
- â€™œ Ordinary language...it lulls us into this platitudinal world of small-talk where everything is taken for granted: life, death, the worldâ€™!

Hinduism

- 23. Ask for sons and grandsons who will live A hundred years. Ask for herds of cattle, Elephants and horses, gold and vast land, And ask toâ€¦
- 5. If a man performs his sacred works when these flames are shining, and the oblations follow at the right time, then they lead him as sun-â€¦
- I am my body; when my body dies, I die.
- t ask me about the secret of death. NACHIKETA These pleasures last but until tomorrow, And they wear out the vital powers of life. How fleeâ€¦
- s longings. It is of the greatest support to all seekers. The Self cannot be known through study Of the scriptures, nor through the intelleâ€¦
- s edge, the sages say, Is the path, difficult to traverse. The supreme Self is beyond name and form, Beyond the senses, inexhaustible, Withâ€¦

Huston Smith

- ...loneliness, withdrawal, identity confusion, and existential dread...Thanks to the fact that our society has become impersonal...
- It should not be assumed from what I have written that the experience was pleasurable. The accurate words are significance and terror.
- Drug experiences that assume a religious cast tend to have fearful and/or beatific features.

Jesus

- Save us, Lord; we are perishing.
- And do not fear those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul. Rather fear him who can destroy both soul and body in hell.

John Bunyan

- For, as I said before, it is evident, that they who live after the flesh in the lusts thereof, do not really and seriously think on death, â€¦

John Shelby Spong

- ...consciousness became self-consciousness and awareness became self-awareness...What was it like in the creatures in whom this new realityâ€¦
- It is one thing to die...It is quite another to know that you are going to die, to plan for it and to accept its inevitability. That was thâ€¦
- Human beings...they will die and are aware that they will disappear...No other living thing before us has ever been required to embrace thiâ€¦
- The sings of the death of a theistic understanding of God are all around us. Many of us will not allow ourselves to see them, because we haâ€¦
- We fear that if theism is dismissed, only a bottomless pit remains.

- Many forms of religion are little more than cultural manifestations of the fear of nothingness. That is why people become hysterical when t  !

Kierkegaard

- And so it is also with the natural man, he is ignorant of what the dreadful truly is, yet he is not thereby exempted from shuddering; no, h  !
- ...one might say perhaps that there lives not one single man who after all is not to some extent in despair, in whose inmost parts there do  !
- So it is that Christianity has taught the Christian to think dauntlessly of everything earthly and worldly, including death. It is almost a  !
- The concept of the sickness unto death must be understood, however, in a peculiar sense. Literally it means a sickness the end and outcome   !
- When death is the greatest danger, one hopes for life; but when one becomes acquainted with an even more dreadful danger, one hopes for dea  !
- No, to be in error or delusion is (quite un-Socratically) the thing they fear the least. One may behold amazing examples which illustrate t  !

Lev Shestov

- In the words of Zarathustra quoted above, a stage of development is formulated which has become for modern man unavoidable. It is no longer  !
- Of God, such a God as he who has understood all the horror of his own helplessness needs, a God who, as Heine put it, "is able to help" - o  !
- What did Nietzsche know? What was his secret? It is in fact a horrible secret and it can be expressed in a few words: "The tortures of Macb  !
- Too clear-sighted and inwardly honest to deceive himself or others, he was finally constrained to remain alone face to face with all the ho  !
- Lightning kills man, diseases torture him to death, other animals take away his food; all this is natural, all this is a part of order of t  !
- Nietzsche's collected works, however, except for the first volume, are dedicated to the solution of the dark enigma of life: idealism or re  !

Martin Heidegger

- ...being towards death has turned out to be an evasion in the face of death- an evasion which conceals.
- The moment of vision, however, brings existence into the Situation and discloses the authentic 'there.'" (Me: This seems to be in the conte  !
- Having been thrown into Being-towards-death, Dasein flees- proximally and for the most part- in the face of this throwness, which has been   !
- indifference' is not the same as embracing death and existence. end of pg. 395-396- 'As the Present leaps away  !' even if one has experience  !

- This event is possible and happens, though only rarely and only for an instant, in the fundamental mood of dread [Angst]. In this sense, â€
- We are "suspended" in dread. More clearly, dread leaves us hanging because it brings on the slipping away of be-ing. So it is that we actuaâ€

Martin Luther

- The more Christian a man is, the more evils, sufferings, and deaths he must endure...
- Thus, when God makes alive, He does it by killing; when He justifies, He does it by bringing in guilty: when He exalts to Heaven, He does iâ€
-) Works are not condemned, but devalued because they are Earthly. The only thing that matters is not of this earth, is not of this Kingdom, â€

Meister Eckhart

- Therefore deadly sin is a breach of nature, a death of the soul, a disquiet of the heart, a weakening of power, a blindness of the sense, aâ€
- The right fear is the fear of losing God.
- To serve God with fear is good; to serve Him out of love is better; but to fear and love Him together is best of all.
- s good works and prayers, as though they had accomplished none, and He is by those means no more favourably inclined towards men than if thâ€

Miguel de Molinos

- It has gotten the name of Hell (Seraphim Rose explained his Nihilism as â€œHell
- The invisible enemies will pursue thee with scruples, lascivious suggestions, and unclean thoughts, with incentives to impatience, pride, râ€
- But fear not: all this is necessary for purging thy Soul, and making it know its own misery, and sensibly perceive the annihilation of all â€
- No sooner wilt thou have given thy self up to thy Lord in this inward Way, but all Hell will conspire against thee, seeing one single Soul â€
- In the time of the recollection, Peace and Resignation of thy Soul, God will more esteem the various impertinent, troublesome and ugly thouâ€
- It is of so great Efficacy, that it rejects worldly Honour, Self-conceit, Spiritual Ambition, the desire of Fame, a wish to be Great, a præ€

Miguel de Unamuno

- For all consciousness is consciousness of death and of suffering.
- Although this meditation upon mortality may soon induce in us a sense of anguish, it fortifies us in the end. Retire, reader, into yourselfâ€
- If we all die utterly, wherefore does everything exist? Wherefore?

- Why do I wish to know whence I come and whither I go, whence comes and whither goes everything that environs me, and what is the meaning of it?
- From the depth of this anguish, from the abyss of the feeling of our mortality, we emerge into the light of another heaven...
- Those who say that they believe in God and yet neither love nor fear Him, do not in fact believe in Him but in those who have taught them to!

Mitchell Heisman

- If reason is incapable of deducing ultimate, nonarbitrary human ends, and nothing can be judged as ultimately more important than anything else?
- Willing death is, then, an attempt to live a nihilistic life.
- If no values are inherently valuable, then life has no inherent value. If life has no inherent purpose, then its end could be directed toward?
- The implications of life's meaninglessness have not been elicited with sufficient ruthlessness. My methodology is honesty to the point of ache?
- When all choices are equal, equality is compatible with total randomness. If all choices are equal, then the choice of death is equal to that?
- Self-consistent materialism leads to interpreting every subjective experience, i.e. fear, love, inspiration, dreams, etc., as physical matter?

Montaigne

- Cicero says- "that to study philosophy is nothing but to prepare one's self to die."
-how much I have less to do with the commodities of life?
- Besides, live as long as you can, you shall by that nothing shorten the space you are to be dead; 'tis all to no purpose; you shall be ever?
- Our very religion itself has no surer human foundation than the contempt of death.
- ...how much I have less to do with the commodities of life, by reason that I begin to lose the use and pleasure of them, by so much I look to?
- he who should teach men to die would at the same time teach them to live.
- ...how is it possible a man should disengage himself from the thought of death, or avoid fancying that it has us every moment by the throat?

Nietzsche

- The most extreme form of nihilism would be the view that every belief, every considering-something-true, is necessarily false because there?
- Even in your folly and despising you each serve your self, you despisers of the body. I tell you, your very self wants to die, and turns away?
- He really supposed that in language he possessed a knowledge of the cosmos. The language builder was not so modest as to believe that he was?

- Christianity as Antiquity. "When on a Sunday morning we hear the old bells ringing, we ask ourselves: Is it possible? All this for a Jew crucified!"
- Formerly it was thought that man's consciousness, his "spirit," offered evidence of his high origin, his divinity. That he might be perfect!
- The public notion of this god now becomes merely a weapon in the hands of clerical agitators, who interpret all happiness as a reward and a debt!

Pascal

- We do not require great education of the mind to understand that there is no real and lasting satisfaction; that our pleasures are only vain!
- If magistrates had true justice, and if physicians had the true art of healing, they would have no occasion for square caps; the majesty of!
- Whatever condition we picture to ourselves, if we muster all the good things which it is possible to possess, royalty is the finest position!
- We do not content ourselves with the life we have in ourselves and in our own being; we desire to live an imaginary life in the mind of others!
- Diversion. "As men are not able to fight against death, misery, ignorance, they have taken it into their heads, in order to be happy, not to!"
- Misery. "The only thing which consoles us for our miseries is diversion, and yet this is the greatest of our miseries. For it is this which!"

Paul Tillich

- ...the concept of the holy was changed. Holiness becomes justice and truth. It is creative and not destructive. The true sacrifice is obedience!
- terrorists
- which are the heritage of everything finite. (acting in the face of death; in spite of how death takes away the meaning, purpose, value of!)

Peter Zappfe

- One night in long bygone times, man awoke and saw himself. He saw that he was naked under cosmos, homeless in his own body. All things dissolved!
- Psychiatry even works on the assumption that the "healthy" and viable is at one with the highest in personal terms. Depression, "fear of life!"
- When a human being takes his life in depression, this is a natural death of spiritual causes. The modern barbarity of "saving" the suicidal!

Plato /Socrates

- And now look again, and see what will naturally follow if the prisoners are released and disabused of their error. At first, when any of them!

- Then I went to one man after another, being not unconscious of the enmity which I provoked, and I lamented and feared this: but necessity wâ€™
- ...the philosopher's mission of searching into myself and other men, I were to desert my post through fear of death, or any other fear; thaâ€™
- For if I tell you that to do as you say would be a disobedience to the God, and therefore that I cannot hold my tongue, you will not believâ€™
- Let us reflect in another way, and we shall see that there is great reason to hope that death is a good; for one of two thingsâ€™ either deathâ€™
- What infinite delight would there be in conversing with them and asking them questions! In another world they do not put a man to death forâ€™

Schopenhauer

- ...misfortune has its uses...If the world were a paradise of luxury and ease, a land flowing with milk and honey, where every Jack obtainedâ€™
- The brute flies from death instinctively without really knowing what it is, and therefore without ever contemplating it in the way natural â€™
- The brute is an embodiment of present impulses, and hence what elements of fear and hope exist in its natureâ€™ and they do not go very farâ€™ arâ€™
- s booth at a fair, and witnesses the performance twice or thrice in succession. The tricks were meant to be seen only once; and when they aâ€™

St. John of the Cross

- ...I see that Jesus Christ is but little known by those who consider themselves His friends. These, loving themselves very much, seek in Hiâ€™
- For in such a way does this dark night of contemplation absorb and immerse the soul in itself, and so near does it bring the soul to God, tâ€™
- For indeed, when this purgative contemplation is most severe, the soul feels very keenly the shadow of death and the lamentations of death â€™
- On this step the lover must see that which he loves, or die...
- â€™œ...I see that Jesus Christ is but little known by those who consider themselves His friends. These, loving themselves very much, seek inâ€™

Swami Vivekananda

- The second is the fear of persecution. A man, for instance, would not like to practice breathing publicly in this country, because he wouldâ€™
- It is vain to preach against the use of symbols, and why should we preach against them? There is no reason why man should not use symbols. â€™
- Where do you ever see love in fear? It is always a sham. With love never comes the idea of fear. Think of a young mother in the street: if â€™

- The perfect man sees nothing but God. So we always worship our highest ideal, and when we have reached the point, when we love the ideal asâ€
- This is not the language of love.â€œ Where do you ever see love in fear? It is always a sham. With love never comes the idea of fear. Think â€

Taoism

- When we renounce learning we have no troubles. The (ready) 'yes,' and (flattering) 'yea;â€ Small is the difference they display. But mark tâ€
- The violent and strong do not die their natural death. I will make this the basis of my teaching.
- When the people do not fear what they ought to fear, that which is their great dread will come on them. Let them not thoughtlessly indulge â€
- â€ Small is the difference they display. But mark their issues, good and ill;â€ What space the gulf between shall fill? What all men fear is â€

Theresa of Avila

- World of light. I tell you it was a piteous and a dreadful thing to see. I knew not where to hide myself, for that shining light, in which â€
- May His Divine Majesty vouchsafe to let us see and taste and understand something of this before He takes us out of this prison-house life,â€
- It is indeed a very great misery to live on in this evil world where our enemies are ever at our gate, and where we can neither eat nor sleâ€
- I reflect at such times on the great hurt our original sin has done us. For it is from our first fall that all this has come to us that we â€
- Those who pray with proper preparation: that is, with much meditation on the whole life and death of our Lord: on their own death: on the lâ€
- And now I return most humbly to beseech your Reverence, that, if you mean to impart to any one these things that you have made me write conâ€

Therese of Lisieux

- ...I felt that one day I should be set free from this land of darkness. I believed it, not only because I had been told so by others, but mâ€
- One morning, in my duty as sacristan, I came to put back the keys of the Communion-grating. This was my work, and I was very pleased to havâ€
- 9 Our Lord has no need of books or teachers to instruct our souls.â€œ Yet all souls cannot be alike. It is necessary that they should differâ€
- â€œNo doubt, dear Mother, you will think I exaggerate somewhat the night of my soul. If you judge by the poems I have composed this year, it â€
- Ah! What attracted me was Jesus hidden in the depths of her soul--Jesus who maketh sweet even that which is most bitter.â€œ (Vivekananda- seeâ€

- s most secret and deepest longings assured me that there was in store for me another and more beautiful country--an abiding dwelling-place.â€¹

Thomas Keating

- Everybody is culturally conditioned to some degree. Even the greatest saints only reach a certain degree of freedom from cultural over-idenâ€¹
- This monk chose the way of spiritual discipline to become the Other. There is at least one other way of negotiating the spiral staircase. Iâ€¹
- ego death

Thomas Kempis

- There is naturally in every man a desire to know, but what profiteth knowledge without the fear of God? Better of a surety is a lowly peasaâ€¹
- There are many foolish and unstable men who say, "See what a prosperous life that man hath, how rich and how great he is, how powerful, howâ€¹
- If it is a fearful thing to die, it may be perchance a yet more fearful thing to live long. Happy is the man who hath the hour of his deathâ€¹
- Always be thou prepared, and so live that death may never find thee unprepared. Many die suddenly and unexpectedly.
- For a perfect contempt of the world, a fervent desire to excel in virtue, the love of discipline, the painfulness of repentance, readiness â€¹
- Ah, foolish one! why thinkest thou that thou shalt live long, when thou art not sure of a single day? How many have been deceived, and suddâ€¹

Thomas Ligotti

- One would think that neuroscientists and geneticists would have as much reason to head for the cliffs because little by little they have beâ€¹
- Consciousness makes it seem as if (1) there is something to do; (2) there is somewhere to go; (3) there is something to be; (4) there is soâ€¹
- ...ego-death is a state that has nothing but anecdotal evidence to support it, which groups this phenomenon with mystical experiences and râ€¹
- Just a little doubt slipped into the mind, a little trickle of suspicion in the bloodstream, and all those eyes of ours, one by one, open uâ€¹
- In his best-known work, *The Denial of Death* (1973), Becker wrote: â€œI believe that those who speculate that a full apprehension of manâ€™s conâ€¹
- All civilizations become defunct. All species die out. There is even an expiration date on the universe itself.

Thomas Merton

- The Fathers of the Church saw that every one of us is more or less like the Prodigal, starving in a distant land, far from our Fatherâ€™s House!
- Without making any distinction between fruitful and sterile leisure, these busy-bodies condemn all desire for leisure as a sin. They believâ€™
- In order to understand even the trivial events of our own lives, we need to create a religious perspective in which to view everything thatâ€™

Timothy Leary

- You select a myth as a reminder that you are part of an ancient and holy process. You select a myth to guide you when you drop out of the nâ€™
- Throughout human history, as our species has faced the frightening, terrorizing fact that we do not know who we are, or where we are going â€™
- or "goodigious high". Say it naturally.â€™ (importance of symbolism to describe the direct experience) â€™œYou select a myth as a reminder thaâ€™

Tolstoy

- I speak of men of our class, of men who are true to themselves, and not of those who make of religion a means of obtaining some temporal adâ€™
- When such an instance does occur, it is not inspired by a desire to make life more simple, but to amass money and make it more sure. Each sâ€™
- I was only astonished that this had not occurred to me before, from premises which had so long been known. Illness and death would come (inâ€™
- no longer taste sweet to me. "My family," thought I; " but a family, a wife and children, are also human beings, and subject to the same coâ€™
- If we turn to those branches of knowledge in which men have tried to find a solution to the problem of life, to physiology, psychology, bioâ€™
- ...I cannot conceal from them the truth every step they take in knowledge leads them to it, and that truth is death." â€™œall those who had seâ€™

Will Durant

- Science does not offer consolation, it offers death. Everything, from the unwinding universe of the astronomers to the college girl irradiâ€™

William James

- "Whilst in this state of philosophic pessimism and general depression of spirits about my prospects, I went one evening into a dressing-rooâ€™
- To prove this point, Tolstoy quotes the Buddha, Solomon, and Schopenhauer. And he finds only four ways in which men of his own class and soâ€™
- The method of averting oneâ€™s attention from evil, and living simply in the light of good is splendid as long as it will work. It will work â€™

- The persons to whom I refer have still retained for the most part their nominal connection with Christianity, in spite of their discarding it!
- Let us see rather whether pity, pain, and fear, and the sentiment of human helplessness may not open a profounder view and put into our hands!
- But this is only the first stage of the world-sickness. Make the human being's sensitiveness a little greater, carry him a little farther on!

William Lane Craig-

- You are the accidental by-product of nature, a result of matter plus time plus chance. There is no reason for your existence. All you face is!
- my death: I am going to die
- The fate of the sons of men and the fate of beasts is the same. As one dies so dies the other; indeed, they all have the same breath and that!
- Human life is mounted upon a subhuman pedestal and must shift for itself alone in the heart of a silent and mindless universe." [4] What is it!
- Look, your baby is going to die anyway. At least save yourself.
- modern man does not feel the chasm that unceasingly surrounds him and that will certainly engulf him at last. Through these remnants, he suffers!

Anxiety

A. W. Tozer

- Our woes began when God was forced out of His central shrine and "things" were allowed to enter. Within the human heart "things" have taken!
- This universal Voice has ever sounded, and it has often troubled men even when they did not understand the source of their fears. Could it be!
- The labor of self-love is a heavy one indeed. Think for yourself whether much of your sorrow has not arisen from someone speaking slighting!
- Our trouble springs from the fact that we who follow Christ inhabit at once two worlds, the spiritual and the natural...Merely to live among!

Albert Camus

- Kierkegaard may shout in warning: "If man had no eternal consciousness, if, at the bottom of everything, there were merely a wild, seething!"
- This cry is not likely to stop the absurd man. Seeking what is true is not seeking what is desirable. If in order to elude the anxious question!

Aldous Huxley

- ...I found myself all at once on the brink of panic. This, I suddenly felt, was going too far. Too far, even though the going was into it!

- From glass, stained or cut, we pass to marble and the other stones that take a high polish and can be used in mass. The fascination exercises its power!
- Upon this psychological foundation has been reared the theological doctrine of saving faith - a doctrine to be met with in all the great religions!
- Most human beings are not philosophers and care not at all for consistency in thought or action.
- is bliss unalloyed and inexpressible. "From glass, stained or cut, we pass to marble and the other stones that take a high polish and can be used in mass."

Augustine

- And finding that Thou maddest them, they give not themselves up to Thee, to preserve what Thou maddest, nor sacrifice to Thee what they have!
- ...I was so tightly held, and from the slavery of worldly business. With increasing anxiety I was going about my usual affairs, and daily sins!
- For it was not salvation that he taught in rhetoric (why, then, should he shrink from naming your name before the sheep of the flock), and sin!
- his reading of the Bible during his experience- "Not in rioting and drunkenness, not in chambering and wantonness, not in strife and envying,"

Bertrand Russell

- In the spectacle of Death, in the endurance of intolerable pain, and in the irrevocableness of a vanished past, there is a sacredness, an awe!
- ...most of them were less anxious to understand the world of science and daily life than to convict it of unreality in the interests of a religion!

Buddhism

- The king himself then went forth to observe everything successively, and to make the gardens even yet more attractive, selecting with care sin!
- "This is a dead man: all his powers of body destroyed, life departed; his heart without thought, his intellect dispersed; his spirit gone, sin!"
- It is not that I am careless about beauty, or am ignorant of the power of human joys, but only that I see on all the impress of change; the impermanence!
- Would that you would listen with attentive mind; we know that you delight to act religiously; it is certain, then, without a doubt, this is sin!
- ...the wise man seeing the bitterness of sorrow, stamps out and destroys the risings of desire; that which the world calls virtue, is but a sin!
- On this, turning his chariot back again, he grieved to think upon the pain of sickness. As a man beaten and wounded sore, with body weakened!

Edgar Saltus

- Added to this, and beyond the insatiable desire to appear serene and successful in the eyes of others, there is the terrible dread of seemiâ€
- It was the rule of his life to expect nothing, desire as little as possible, and learn all he could, and as little was to be expected and nâ€
- Chamfort says somewhere, very wittily, "It is sometimes said of a man that he lives alone and does not care for society; this is very much â€
- It is sometimes said of a man that he lives alone and does not care for society; this is very much the same as saying that he does not careâ€

Emile Cioran

- in death one loses everything, by a fall into nothingness. that is why the fear of death is persistent and essential, but actually less strâ€
- the world in which nothing is solved. to doubt and yet to live - this is a paradox, though not a tragic one, since doubt is less intense, lâ€
- i might become an animal who knows the history of philosophy. as to becoming superman, that seems to me utter and ridiculous folly. could tâ€
- i do not know what is right and what is wrong; what is allowed and what is not; i cannot judge and i cannot praise. there are no valid critâ€
- the feeling of utter confusion! not to be able to differentiate, clarify, understand, or appreciate! such a feeling would make any philosopâ€
- he who has not experienced absolute fear, universal anxiety, cannot understand struggle, the madness of the flesh and of death.

Ernest Becker

- It was Rank who very early admitted that anxiety could not all be overcome therapeutically, and this is what he meant: that it is impossiblâ€
- crazy": he is not in anythingâ€™s world. (Ha!) â€œThe irony of mans condition is that the deepest need is to be free of the anxiety of death â€
- ...the final terror of self-consciousness is the knowledge of oneâ€™s own death, which is the peculiar sentence on man alone in the animal kiâ€
- Kierkegaard's torment was the direct result of seeing the world as it really is in relation to his situation as a creature. The prison of oâ€
- The flood of anxiety is not the end for man. It is, rather, a â€œschool
- ...by the destruction of the self through facing up to the anxiety of the terror of existence. The self must be destroyed, brought down to â€

Evelyn Underhill

- The question is not, whence come those conditions which provoke in the self the experiences called sorrow, anxiety, pain: but, why do theseâ€

- If it is to be vanquished, either the disharmony must be resolved by a deliberate and careful adjustment of the self to the world of sense,â€
- terrible p. 20 initiative caress of God
- She disguised herself in a hermit's dress- she had no one to help or advise her--and "went out of her chamber about Four in the Morning, taâ€
- Fuss and feverishness, anxiety, intensity, intolerance, instability, pessimism and wobble, and every kind of hurry and worryâ€ these, even oâ€
- We see that plainly in the Saints; in the quiet steadiness of spirit with which they meet the vicissitudes and sufferings of their lives. Tâ€

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- ...the universality of faith, seeing it as underlying all human activity and knowledge; and we have seen that faith, if it is not to fall pâ€
- This "anxiety" and this "abyss" are precisely the nothingness out of which God has called each man into being, and back to which man seems â€
- ...let me before I call it a Christian actâ€ carefully ask myself whether its end is merely a lofty worldly ideal, or something greater.
- anxiety
- others, Vivekananda) â€œYou speak of â€œChristian action,â€ â€œthe Christian who manifests the truth of the Gospel in social action,â€ â€œnot only inâ€

Herman TÃ¸nnessen

- ...cognitive...empathetic 'disintegrity'...to hold cognitively incompatible views or positions...to prevent knowledge from penetrating 'volâ€
- Ordinary language...it lulls us into this platitudinal world of small-talk where everything is taken for granted: life, death, the world, aâ€
- If a student has difficulties in getting to the university because of their fear of stepping on cracks in the pavement, this is not a problâ€
- (Kierkegaard) constrains out of him all his puny, piddling hatreds, and petty ambitions in brass and bridge, and fills him with care and coâ€

Jesus

- Therefore do not be anxious, saying, â€What shall we eat?â€ or â€What shall we drink?â€ or â€What shall we wear?â€ For the Gentiles seek after alâ€

John Shelby Spong

- ...consciousness became self-consciousness and awareness became self-awareness...What was it like in the creatures in whom this new realityâ€
- Human beings...they will die and are aware that they will disappear...No other living thing before us has ever been required to embrace thiâ€

- The fires of anxiety, born in self-consciousness, are thus banked by religion and we are content, if not grateful, to live inside the theisâ€¹
- It is an act of enormous courage to embrace what it means to be a self-conscious human being. It is not easy to live with the awareness of â€¹

Kierkegaard

- ...one might say perhaps that there lives not one single man who after all is not to some extent in despair, in whose inmost parts there doâ€¹
- O when one beholds a man who protests that he has entirely understood how Christ went about in the form of a lowly servant, poor, despised,â€¹
- God is surely the word which occurs most frequently in daily speech and is absolutely the word to which one attaches the least meaning and â€¹
- Alas, it is horrible to see a man rush toward his own destruction. It is horrible to see him dance on the rim of the abyss without any intiâ€¹
- But then there was one horse that was all alone. Now when this horse heard the call, when he saw that the herd was gathering in the eveningâ€¹
- Oh, you sufferer, whoever you may be, if your suffering was not hidden because you wished to hide it (for then you can manage; your action â€¹

Lev Shestov

- Anyone who has studied Nietzsche carefully cannot doubt that his attacks are directed not against Christianity nor against the gospel, but â€¹
- For it was one of two things: either Nietzsche was right, or his tragedy was indeed so profound, so unprecedentedly horrible that all peoplâ€¹
- Two things have, I hope, become fairly clear to us by now. On the one hand, Kierkegaard resolves to suspend the "ethical," which is the expâ€¹
- he even prides himself on this art and finds a particular charm in it.â€¹â€œFor it was one of two things: either Nietzsche was right, or his tâ€¹
- s collected works, however, except for the first volume, are dedicated to the solution of the dark enigma of life: idealism or reality. Nieâ€¹
- s Christianity.â€¹â€œ (I am having so much trouble because my philosophy is too

Martin Heidegger

- What anxiety is about is being in the world itself.
- The moment of vision, however, brings existence into the Situation and discloses the authentic 'there'." (Me: This seems to be in the conteâ€¹
- In particular, that in the face of which one has anxiety is not encountered as something definite with which one can concern oneself; the thâ€¹
- Anxiety discloses an insignificance of the world; and this insignificance reveals the nullity of that with which one can concern oneself- oâ€¹

- Anxiety liberates him from possibilities which 'count for nothing', and lets him become free for those which are authentic.
- indifference' is not the same as embracing death and existence. end of pg. 395-396- 'As the Present leaps away' even if one has experience'

Martin Luther

- ...an ungodly man, like Satan his prince, is wholly turned to self and to his own. He does not seek God, nor care for the things of God: he'
- It is ineffective (you say) and can do nothing of good...without the grace of God, it is ineffective. Great Earthly/Other distinction/conc'

Meister Eckhart

- Here, thou shouldest know that in every man are two kinds of men, the outer and the inner man. Every man, who loves God, only uses his oute'
- s good works and prayers, as though they had accomplished none, and He is by those means no more favourably inclined towards men than if th'

Miguel de Molinos

- Many Souls when they suffer these painful torments, are troubled, afflicted, and disquieted, it seeming to them, that they begin already in'
- Here thou art to shut up the Senses, trusting God with all the care of thy Welfare, and minding nothing of the affairs this Life.
- In the time of the recollection, Peace and Resignation of thy Soul, God will more esteem the various impertinent, troublesome and ugly thou'
- How many have begun this happy practice of Prayer, and Internal Recollection, and have left it off, pretending that they feel no pleasure, '
- St. Paul (I Tim. 4.) recommended to us first the care of our own Souls, before that of our Neighbour. Take heed unto thy self, and unto thy'
- When the Soul begins to retire from the World and Vice, it ought to tame the body with rigour, that it may be subject to the Spirit and fol'

Miguel de Unamuno

- Like Pascal, I do not understand those who assert that they care not a farthing for these things, and this indifference " in a matter that '
- And they have made a religion of art, a cure for the metaphysical evil, and invented the meaningless phrase of art for art's sake. And it d'
- anxiety
- s sake. And it does not suffice them. If the man who tells you that he writes, paints, sculptures, or sings for his own amusement, gives hi'

Nietzsche

- Everyone looks at you with strange eyes, and continues to make use of his scales, calling this good and that bad ; and no one blushes for sâ€!
- The two physiological facts upon which it grounds itself and upon which it bestows its chief attention are: first, an excessive sensitiveneâ€!
- To be sure, the accident of environment, of educational background gives prominence to concepts of a certain sort: in primitive Christianitâ€!
- A prince at the head of his armies, magnificent as the expression of the egoism and arrogance of his people--and yet acknowledging, withoutâ€!
- There are days when I am visited by a feeling blacker than the blackest melancholy--contempt of man. Let me leave no doubt as to what I desâ€!
- Yes, a dying for many has here been devised, which glorifies itself as life: truly, a hearty service to all preachers of death! The state, â€!

Pascal

- We do not require great education of the mind to understand that here is no real and lasting satisfaction; that our pleasures are only vaniâ€!
- Whence comes it that this man, who lost his only son a few months ago, or who this morning was in such trouble through being distressed by â€!
- Diversion.â€"Men are entrusted from infancy with the care of their honour, their property, their friends, and even with the property and the â€!
- We do not trouble ourselves about being esteemed in the towns through which we pass. But if we are to remain a little while there, we are sâ€!
- Nothing is so important to man as his own state, nothing is so formidable to him as eternity; and thus it is not natural that there should â€!
- If, at the bottom of their heart, they are troubled at not having more light, let them not disguise the fact; this avowal will not be shameâ€!

Paul Tillich

- The description of anxiety as the awareness of one's finitude is sometimes criticized as untrue from the point of view of the ordinary statâ€!
- But the underlying structure of finite life is the universal condition which makes the appearance of anxiety under special conditions possiâ€!
- Many Christians, as well as other religious groups, feel anxiety, guilt and despair about what they call 'loss of faith.' But serious doubtâ€!
- It is experienced in passion, anxiety, despair, ecstasy.
- s finitude is sometimes criticized as untrue from the point of view of the ordinary state of mind. Anxiety, one says, appears under specialâ€!

Peter Zappfe

- In everyday interaction, isolation is manifested in a general code of mutual silence: primarily toward children, so these are not at once sâ€™!
- Only a limited part of humanity can make do with mere â€˜changesâ€™™, whether in work, social life, or entertainment. The cultured person demandâ€™!
- the absence of naturally (biologically) based spiritual activity shows up, for example, in the pervasive recourse to distraction (entertainmâ€™!

Plato /Socrates

- ...are you not ashamed of heaping up the greatest amount of money and honour and reputation, and caring so little about wisdom and truth anâ€™!
- For I do nothing but go about persuading you all, old and young alike, not to take thought for your persons or your properties, but first aâ€™!
- What return shall be made to the man who has never had the wit to be idle during his whole life; but has been careless of what the many carâ€™!
- Still I have a favour to ask of them. When my sons are grown up, I would ask you, O my friends, to punish them; and I would have you troublâ€™!
- ...I desire to prove to you that the real philosopher has reason to be of good cheer when he is about to die, and that after death he may hâ€™!
- But the soul which has been polluted, and is impure at the time of her departure, and is the companion and servant of the body always, and â€™!

Schopenhauer

- The crowd of miserable wretches whose one aim in life is to fill their purses but never to put anything into their heads, offers a singularâ€™!
- s booth at a fair, and witnesses the performance twice or thrice in succession. The tricks were meant to be seen only once; and when they aâ€™!

St. John of the Cross

- The soul, therefore, that will ascend to this perfect union with God, must be careful not to lean upon imaginary visions, forms, figures, aâ€™!
- The second sign whereby a man may believe himself to be experiencing the said purgation is that the memory is ordinarily centred upon God, â€™!
- For in such a way does this dark night of contemplation absorb and immerse the soul in itself, and so near does it bring the soul to God, tâ€™!
- ...immersed in the realization of those evils wherein it sees its own miseries so clearly, that it thinks that, as its director observes noâ€™!
- No one can help me. I am scared that I know that they can't do anything for me. Even more terrifying: they may not even understand me. Theyâ€™!
- â€œ...I see that Jesus Christ is but little known by those who consider themselves His friends. These, loving themselves very much, seek inâ€™!

Swami Vivekananda

- But I must ask you to bear in mind that, as there is religious superstition, so also there is a superstition in the matter of science. Thereâ€™
- Where do you ever see love in fear? It is always a sham. With love never comes the idea of fear. Think of a young mother in the street: if â€
- The perfect man sees nothing but God. So we always worship our highest ideal, and when we have reached the point, when we love the ideal asâ€™
- s name, like Darwin or Huxley, is cited, we follow blindly. It is the fashion of the day...True science asks us to be cautious. Just as we â€
- This is not the language of love.â€œ â€œWhere do you ever see love in fear? It is always a sham. With love never comes the idea of fear. Think â€

Taoism

- When we renounce learning we have no troubles. The (ready) 'yes,' and (flattering) 'yea;â€™ Small is the difference they display. But mark tâ€™
- He who knows (the Tao) does not (care to) speak (about it); he who is (ever ready to) speak about it does not know itâ€™He (who knows it) wilâ€™
- the kingdom is made one's own (only) by freedom from action and purpose. How do I know that it is so? By these facts:â€™ In the kingdom the mâ€™
- (It is the way of the Tao) to act without (thinking of) acting; to conduct affairs without (feeling the) trouble of them; to taste without â€
- With these three qualities, it cannot be made the subject of description; and hence we blend them together and obtain The One. Its upper paâ€™
- er it we should mourn.) When things have become strong, they (then) become old, which may be said to be contrary to the Tao. Whatever is coâ€™

Theresa of Avila

- O my Lord, why keepest Thou Thy servant in this miserable life so long, where all is such vexation, and disappointment, and manifold troublâ€™
- he cares nothing if he loses everything, nor does he count this as loss.
- I repeat that this consists mainly or entirely in our ceasing to care about ourselves and our own pleasures, for the least that anyone who â€
- This house is another Heaven, if it be possible to have Heaven upon earth. Anyone whose sole pleasure lies in pleasing God and who cares noâ€™
- For it is in this way that you will begin to gain freedom; soon you will not care if they speak ill or well of you; it will seem like someoâ€™
- Would it not be gross ignorance, my daughters, if, when a man was questioned about his name, or country, or parents, he could not answer? Sâ€™

Therese of Lisieux

- There are, of course, no enemies in the Carmel; but, after all, we have our natural likes and dislikes. We may feel drawn towards one Sister!
- One morning, in my duty as sacristan, I came to put back the keys of the Communion-grating. This was my work, and I was very pleased to have!
- Seeing one of our Sisters very much fatigued, I said to Soeur Therese: "It grieves me to see people suffer, especially those who are holy."!
- If your desire be to draw great profit, do not go with the idea of procuring relaxation, but rather with the intention of entertaining others!
- and all the Community thought I had yielded to natural reluctance. I cannot tell you what profit I derived from this incident, and it made me!
- Ah! What attracted me was Jesus hidden in the depths of her soul--Jesus who maketh sweet even that which is most bitter. (Vivekananda- see!)

Thomas Keating

- The spiritual journey is not a career or a success story. It is a series of humiliations of the false self that become more and more profound!

Thomas Kempis

- How came it to pass that many of the Saints were so perfect, so contemplative of Divine things? Because they steadfastly sought to mortify themselves!
- So long as we live in the world, we cannot be without trouble and trial.
- There are many foolish and unstable men who say, "See what a prosperous life that man hath, how rich and how great he is, how powerful, how!"
- If thou art not anxious for thyself now, who, thinkest thou, will be anxious for thee afterwards?
- Ah, foolish one! why thinkest thou that thou shalt live long, when thou art not sure of a single day? How many have been deceived, and suddenly!
- ...do many things displease thee and often trouble thee, that thou art not yet perfectly dead to thyself nor separated from all earthly things!

Thomas Ligotti

- Can one really believe in determinism without going insane?...And those who really care cannot be anything but believers in some form of moralism!
- ...And those who really care cannot be anything but believers in some form of moral realism or moralism,
- Some morbid citizens among us might become cataleptic with anxiety because their next breath may be their last, but most of us would not be!
-)œOne day those shoes on the floor of your clothes closet may attract your eye in a way they never have before. Somehow they have become abominable!

Tolstoy

- There was, he said, one infallible rule, and that was to have no care about the worldly life.
- The new circumstances of a happy family life by which I was now surrounded completely led my mind away from the search after the meaning of life!
- no longer taste sweet to me. "My family," thought I; "but a family, a wife and children, are also human beings, and subject to the same conditions!"
- (1) that the position assumed by Schopenhauer, Solomon, and myself, with all our wisdom, was a foolish one: we understand that life is an enigma!
- We say, It is difficult to live according to the doctrine of Jesus! And why should it not be difficult, when by our organization of life we make it so?
- I once thought that if a foreign invasion occurred, or even if evil-minded persons attacked me, and I did not defend myself, I should be rewarded!

William James

- The impulse to expiate and do penance is, in its first intention, far too immediate and spontaneous an expression of self-despair and anxiety!
- s Other, not good. Which is why Augustine says that Evil is negative in existence since evil is simply a lack of goodness. "Let us see rather!"

Lack of Objective Meaning/Value/Purpose

A. W. Tozer

- He had concentrated his all in the person of his dear son, and God had taken it from him. God could have begun out on the margin of Abraham's life!
- ...the rending of the veil...is nothing pleasant...To tear it away is to injure us, to hurt us and make us bleed. To say otherwise is to make a mockery of life!
- In the world of men we find nothing approaching the virtues of which Jesus spoke in the opening words of the famous Sermon on the Mount. In fact!
- The labor of self-love is a heavy one indeed. Think for yourself whether much of your sorrow has not arisen from someone speaking slightlying!
- s life and worked inward to the center; He chose rather to cut quickly to the heart and have it over in one sharp act of separation. In death!

Albert Camus

- Men, too, secrete the inhuman. At certain moments of lucidity, the mechanical aspect of their gestures, their meaningless pantomime makes sense!
- Does not the failure reveal, beyond any possible explanation and interpretation, not the absence but the existence of transcendence?" That is!

- Nothing more profound, for example, than Kierkegaard's view according to which despair is not a fact but a state: the very state of sin. For
- Kierkegaard may shout in warning: "If man had no eternal consciousness, if, at the bottom of everything, there were merely a wild, seething
- The absurd man thus catches sight of a burning and frigid, transparent and limited universe in which nothing is possible but everything is
- Thus the absurd becomes god (in the broadest meaning of this word) and that inability to understand becomes the existence that illuminates

Aldous Huxley

- As recently as three hundred years ago an expression of thoroughgoing world denial and even world condemnation was both orthodox and common
- ...no saint or founder of a religion, no exponent of the Perennial Philosophy, has ever been optimistic. 'Many are called, but few are chosen'
- The best that can be said for ritualistic legalism is that it improves conduct. It does little, however, to alter character and nothing of
- In statements such as Eckhart's, God is equated with nothing.
- The Christ of the Gospels is a preacher and not a dispenser of sacraments or performer of rites; he speaks against vain repetitions; he insists
- For the Buddha of the Pali scriptures, ritual was one of the fetters holding back the soul from enlightenment and liberation. Nevertheless,

Angela of Foligno

- "Blessed (saith He), verily blessed is, and shall be, he who loveth poverty in all the aforesaid things and who desireth to be truly poor in

Augustine

- Suddenly every vain hope became worthless to me.
- How wretched was it! and Thou didst irritate the feeling of its wound, that forsaking all else, it might be converted unto Thee, who art above
- ...the joy of a faithful hope lieth incomparably beyond such vanity.
- And when this power of reason within me also found that it was changeable, it raised itself up to its own intellectual principle, and withdrew
- Thou saidst that for an uncertain truth thou likest not to cast off the baggage of vanity; now, it is certain, and yet that burden still oppresses
- For he saw that the causes of things were sought for by them,--which causes he believed to be ultimately reducible to nothing else than the

Bertrand Russell

- And Man said: "There is a hidden purpose, could we but fathom it, and the purpose is good; for we must reverence something, and in the vision"
- In the spectacle of Death, in the endurance of intolerable pain, and in the irrevocableness of a vanished past, there is a sacredness, an oath"
- To take into the inmost shrine of the soul the irresistible forces whose puppets we seem to be—"Death and change, the irrevocableness of the"
- To abandon the struggle for private happiness, to expel all eagerness of temporary desire, to burn with passion for eternal things—"this is "

Buddhism

- my fear of birth, old age, disease, and death, has led me to disobey, and disregard his extreme kindness. Whoever neglects right consideration"
- the appearance of lustful desire; the wise man will have nothing to do with it; he would rather throw his body into the water or fire, or cast"
- "Absence, extinction, and unoccupancy--these are not the Buddhist conception of emptiness. Buddhists' Emptiness is not on the plane of relation"
- s life; hearing of my father, the king, and his grief, my heart is affected with increased love; but yet, all is like the fancy of a dream,""

C. S. Lewis

- Finally, if reality at its very root is so meaningless to us—"or, putting it the other way round, if we are such total imbeciles—"what is the"

Ecclesiastes

- All is vanity.
- ...the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing. What has been is what will be, and what has been done is what will be"
- I have seen everything that is done under the sun, and behold, all is vanity and a striving after wind. What is crooked cannot be made straight"
- So I became great and I surpassed all who were before me in Jerusalem. Also my wisdom remained with me. And whatever my eyes desired I did"
- They all have the same breath, and man has no advantage over the beasts, for all is vanity. All go to one place. All are from the dust, and"
- The more words, the more vanity, and what is the advantage to man? For who knows what is good for man while he lives the few days of his vain"

Edgar Saltus

- He was not much over twenty before excessive study had well-nigh ruined such health as he once possessed. The slightest application was wear"

- Leopardi at that time was in his twenty-seventh year, and the task to which he then devoted himself was, he said, to be the sad ending of a life!
- The Buddhist believes that the soul migrates until Nirvāṇa is attained, and that in the preparation for this state, which is the death of Dhamma!
- ...any man who has begun to dislike the propinquity of the average, and to feel that where the crowd find amusement there will be nothing but!
- To all this advanced pessimism has a ready answer: first, there can be no morality, for where there is no body and no property it is impossible!
- To sum up, then, what has gone before, the modern pessimist is a Buddhist who has strayed from the Orient, and who in his exodus has left behind!

Emile Cioran

- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreams!
- the most terrifying intensification bursts into nothingness. you grow inside, you dilate madly until there are no boundaries left, you react!
- at the edge of life everything is an occasion for death...every experience is in this case a leap into nothingness.
- the passion for the absurd. there are no arguments. Can anyone who has reached the limit bother with arguments, causes, effects, moral consequences!
- i feel i must burst because of all that life offers me and because of the prospect of death. i feel that i am dying of solitude, of love, of life!
- i live because the mountains do not laugh and the worms do not sing. the passion for the absurd can grow only in a man who has exhausted everything!

Ernest Becker

- Man's body is a problem to him that has to be explained. Not only his body is strange, but also its inner landscape, the memories and dreams!
- Kierkegaard's torment was the direct result of seeing the world as it really is in relation to his situation as a creature. The prison of life!
- ...by the destruction of the self through facing up to the anxiety of the terror of existence. The self must be destroyed, brought down to earth!
- We have seen that what we call the human character is actually a lie about the nature of reality. The causa-sui project is a pretense that life!
- Rank calls this a paradoxical but deep insight into the essence of neurosis, and he sums it up in the words we have used as an epigraph to life!
- I am nothing.

Evelyn Underhill

- Those who are temperamentally inclined to credulity may become naturalists, and persuade themselves to believe in the reality of the sense
- Certain facts of which too keen a perception would act detrimentally to the life-force are, for most men, impossible of realization: i.e. ,
- Nothing can be more certain than that man is not so content. He has been called by utilitarian philosophers a tool-making animal
- Why, after all, take as our standard a material world whose existence is affirmed by nothing more trustworthy than the sense-impressions of
- ...you will find it impossible to prove that the world as seen by the mystics, is unimaginable, formless, dark with excess of bright, is less
- The intellect by itself moves nothing,

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- And indeed the Christian is, in a certain sense--in an ultimate sense--a "Nihilist"; for to him, in the end, the world is nothing, and God
- To him who lives in Christ, of course, many of the goods of this world may be given back, and he may enjoy them even while realizing their
- Such is the Nihilist universe, in which there is neither up nor down, right nor wrong, true nor false, because there is no longer any point
- The whole world, it almost seems, is divided into those who lead meaningless, futile lives without being aware of it, and those who, being
- The atheist arguments against such a god are as irrefutable as they are irrelevant; for such a god is, in fact, the same as no god at all.
- If there is no immortality, the Liberal believes, one can still lead a civilized life; "if there is no immortality"-is the far profounder

GK Chesterton

- If a man says that extinction is better than existence or blank existence better than variety and adventure, then he is not one of the ordinary

Herman Tjallingii

- Ordinary language...it lulls us into this platitudinal world of small-talk where everything is taken for granted: life, death, the world, and
- One of the simplest forms of suffocation (offering happiness and peace of mind through the most comfortable evasions and illusions) consists
- If a student has difficulties in getting to the university because of their fear of stepping on cracks in the pavement, this is not a problem
- to do to keep the labor force under a sufficiently permanent sedation. One of the simplest forms of suffocation (offering happiness and peace

Hinduism

- 23. Ask for sons and grandsons who will live A hundred years. Ask for herds of cattle, Elephants and horses, gold and vast land, And ask toâ€¦!
- 5. If a man performs his sacred works when these flames are shining, and the oblations follow at the right time, then they lead him as sun-â€¦!

Jesus

- Godliness with contentment is great gain. For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out. And having foâ€¦!

John Shelby Spong

- It means that if life has no ultimate meaning, we alone of all other creatures embrace the threat of meaninglessness.
- Many forms of religion are little more than cultural manifestations of the fear of nothingness. That is why people become hysterical when tâ€¦!

Kierkegaard

- So it is that Christianity has taught the Christian to think dauntlessly of everything earthly and worldly, including death. It is almost aâ€¦!
- This view will doubtless seem to many a paradox, an exaggeration, and a gloomy and depressing view at that. Yet it is nothing of the sort. â€¦!
- But in spite of the fact that a man has become fantastic in this fashion, he may nevertheless (although most commonly it becomes manifest) â€¦!
- So the despairing self is constantly building nothing but castles in the air, it fights only in the air. All these experimented virtues makâ€¦!
- For how does it come about that a man's life becomes so spiritlessâ€¦!? No, it is manâ€™s own fault. No man is born with spiritlessness, and howâ€¦!
- So he despairs. His despair is that of weakness, a passive suffering of the self, in contrast to the despair of self-assertion; but, by theâ€¦!

Lev Shestov

- Has Tolstoy the right to demand of us that we, without doubting the good faith and sincerity of his words, must accept his proclamation thaâ€¦!
- I repeat, it is an error to think that Nietzsche's experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it occurs perhaps much more â€¦!
- Almost everything about which Nietzsche wrote is absolutely removed from the ordinary ideas of human thought and from the experience of theâ€¦!
- He clearly had the right to consider himself "beyond good and evil," irrespective of the fact that he knew how necessary and useful the conâ€¦!

- ...that the method of inquiry into the truth lies not in a search for "the self-movement of the concept," (discovered by Hegel) but in willâ€¦
- No one has power over the body or over the world. That means there is nothing we can do: let the world exist for itself as it pleases or asâ€¦

Martin Heidegger

- The moment of vision, however, brings existence into the Situation and discloses the authentic 'there'." (Me: This seems to be in the conteâ€¦
- In particular, that in the face of which one has anxiety is not encountered as something definite with which one can concern oneself; the thâ€¦
- Anxiety liberates him from possibilities which 'count for nothing', and lets him become free for those which are authentic.
- indifference' is not the same as embracing death and existence. end of pg. 395-396- 'As the Present leaps awayâ€¦' even if one has experienceâ€¦
- Dasein is always 'there'- that is to say, in that public disclosedness of Being-with-one-another where the loudest idle talk and the most iâ€¦
- We miss a 'positive' content in that which is called, because we expect to be told something currently useful about assured possibilities oâ€¦

Martin Luther

- God forbid! Even if God were to offer me paradise in order that I might last forty more years in this life, I wouldn't want it. I'd rather â€¦
- Therefore, it is not irreligious, curious, or superfluous, but essentially wholesome and necessary, for a Christian to know, whether or notâ€¦
- You make the power of "Free-will" to beâ€¦"that certain small degree of power, which, without the grace of God, is utterly ineffective.' Do yâ€¦
- For in this way, I will make it appear, that a stone, or a log of wood has "Freewill," because it can go upwards and downwards; although, bâ€¦
- free will since anything to do with free will is necessarily Earthly, and God, or the Other, is not only valuable, but the Ground of all Vaâ€¦
- It is ineffective (you say) and can do nothing of good...without the grace of God, it is ineffective.â€© Great Earthly/Other distinction/concâ€¦

Meister Eckhart

- Only he knows God who recognizes that all creatures are nothingness.
- God has remained from everlasting in immovable sanctity, and still remains so. When He created heaven and earth and all creatures, His sancâ€¦
- Here, thou shouldest know that in every man are two kinds of men, the outer and the inner man. Every man, who loves God, only uses his outeâ€¦

- "What is the object of this immovable sanctity?" I answer, "Nothing" – For this we may take the following illustration: if we bake in one oven!
- The question arises: But what then does the sanctified heart pray for? I answer that when truly sanctified, it prays for nothing, for whose!
- The quickest means to bring us to perfection is suffering; none enjoy everlasting blessedness more than those who share with Christ the bitter!

Miguel de Molinos

- The way to attain that high state of a Mind reformed, whereby a man immediately gets to the greatest Good, to our first Original, and to that!
- But the happy Soul which is gotten to this holy hatred of it self, lives overwhelmed, drowned and swallowed up in the depth of its own Nothing!
- The Senses are not capable of divine Blessings; hence if thou would be Happy and Wise; be Silent and Believe; Suffer and have Patience; be!
- Think not that when thou art dry and darksome in the presence of God, with faith and silence, that thou do'st nothing, that thou lovest time!
- All our righteousness (as Isaiah saith) are as filthy rags, (Chap. 64. 6.) through the stains of vanity, conceitedness, and self-love. It is!
- Here thou art to shut up the Senses, trusting God with all the care of thy Welfare, and minding nothing of the affairs this Life.

Miguel de Unamuno

- If consciousness is, as some inhuman thinker has said, nothing more than a flash of light between two eternities of darkness, then there is!
- All knowledge has an ultimate object. Knowledge for the sake of knowledge is, say what you will, nothing but a dismal begging of the question!
- Science exists only in personal consciousness and thanks to it; astronomy, mathematics, have no other reality than that which they possess!
- If you look at the universe as closely and as inwardly as you are able to look – that is to say, if you look within yourself; if you not only!
- We personalize the All in order to save ourselves from Nothingness; and the only mystery really mysterious is the mystery of suffering. Suffer!
- Although this meditation upon mortality may soon induce in us a sense of anguish, it fortifies us in the end. Retire, reader, into yourself!

Mitchell Heisman

- If reason is incapable of deducing ultimate, nonarbitrary human ends, and nothing can be judged as ultimately more important than anything!
- Can one live a philosophy of the nihilistic, reconciling meaninglessness with every thought and emotion at every moment? If active unbelief!

- The implications of life's meaninglessness have not been elicited with sufficient ruthlessness. My methodology is honesty to the point of
- When all choices are equal, equality is compatible with total randomness. If all choices are equal, then the choice of death is equal to
- If life is truly meaningless and there is no rational basis for choosing among fundamental alternatives, then all choices are equal and
- For some, the meaninglessness gleaned from a scientific view of life leads to nausea, angst, and nihilistic despair. I reject this attitude

Montaigne

- Cicero says- "that to study philosophy is nothing but to prepare one's self to die." -how much I have less to do with the commodities of
- Besides, live as long as you can, you shall by that nothing shorten the space you are to be dead; 'tis all to no purpose; you shall be ever
- that to study philosophy is nothing but to prepare one's self to die.
- s self to die." -how much I have less to do with the commodities of life, by reason that I begin to lose the use and pleasure of them, by

Nietzsche

- What is your greatest experience? It is the hour of the great contempt. The hour in which even your happiness becomes repulsive to you, and
- The philosophical nihilist is convinced that all that happens is meaningless and in vain; and that there ought not to be anything meaningle
- It was morality that protected life against despair and the leap into nothing.
- We have killed him (God), you and I! We are all his murderers! But how have we done it? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us
- But the castration, against all nature, of such a god, making him a god of goodness alone, would be contrary to human inclination. Mankind
- The Christian concept of a god--the god as the patron of the sick, the god as a spinner of cobwebs, the god as a spirit--is one of the most

Pascal

- We do not require great education of the mind to understand that there is no real and lasting satisfaction; that our pleasures are only vani
- The vanity of the sciences."Physical science will not console me for the ignorance of morality in the time of affliction.
- Let him see therein an infinity of universes, each of which has its firmament, its planets, its earth, in the same proportion as in the vis
- Let us then take our compass; we are something, and we are not everything. The nature of our existence hides from us the knowledge of first

- This is our true state; this is what makes us incapable of certain knowledge and of absolute ignorance. We sail within a vast sphere, ever â€
- The consciousness of the falsity of present pleasures, and the ignorance of the vanity of absent pleasures, cause inconstancy.

Paul Tillich

- All speaking about divine matters which is not done in the state of ultimate concern is meaningless.
- Here again it would be meaningless to ask whether one or another of the figures in which an ultimate concern is symbolized does 'exist.' Ifâ€
- As a theoretical judgement claiming general validity, it is a meaningless combination of words. But in the correlation between the subject â€
- The answer must accept, as its precondition, the state of meaninglessness. It is not an answer if it demands the removal of this state; forâ€
- , Vivekananda saying nothing will make us ultimately content in this world of Maya) Faith- â€œ...is the passion for the infinite.â€® Ultimate Câ€
- t recognize it, are stuck in the nightmare of existence, the human condition is universal) â€œ...even an idolatrous faith can hide this conseâ€

Peter Zappfe

- Only a limited part of humanity can make do with mere â€˜changesâ€™™, whether in work, social life, or entertainment. The cultured person demandâ€
- If we continue these considerations to the bitter end, then the conclusion is not in doubt. As long as humankind recklessly proceeds in theâ€

Plato /Socrates

- But the simple truth is, O Athenians, that I have nothing to do with physical speculations.
- When I began to talk with him, I could not help thinking that he was not really wise, although he was thought wise by many, and still wiserâ€
- At last I went to the artisans. I was conscious that I knew nothing at all, as I may say, and I was sure that they knew many fine things; â€
- This inquisition has led to my having many enemies of the worst and most dangerous kind, and has given occasion also to many calumnies. Andâ€
- For I do nothing but go about persuading you all, old and young alike, not to take thought for your persons or your properties, but first â€
- Let us reflect in another way, and we shall see that there is great reason to hope that death is a good; for one of two thingsâ€”either deathâ€

Pseudo-Dionysius

- Therewith, they learn that It is the Cause of all things and yet Itself is nothing, because It super-essentially transcends them all.
- “Therewith, they learn that It is the Cause of all things and yet Itself is nothing, because It super-essentially transcends them all.”

Schopenhauer

- The crowd of miserable wretches whose one aim in life is to fill their purses but never to put anything into their heads, offers a singular
- This is the realm of finality; and its opposite would be an infinite existence, exposed to no attack from without, and needing nothing to
- Were it of any value in itself, anything unconditioned and absolute, it could not thus end in mere nothing.
- s booth at a fair, and witnesses the performance twice or thrice in succession. The tricks were meant to be seen only once; and when they

St. John of the Cross

- The doctrine of Christ which He came into the world to teach, is contempt of all things, that we may thereby have power to receive the reward
- The whole creation (all wisdom, sweetness, goodness, liberty, riches, etc.), compared with the infinite Being of God, is nothing; and so the
- The earth “void and nothing,” signifies that the earth and all it contains are nothing, and the heavens without light, that all the lights
- The whole creation, compared with the infinite Being of God, is nothing; and so the soul whose affections are set on created things is nothing
- This God himself will do during the observance of the first two commandments; He will change them from old into new, by infusing into the soul
- I mean ways of understanding, perceiving, or feeling, though it has all ways at the same time, as one who, possessing nothing, yet possesses

Swami Vivekananda

- The second is the fear of persecution. A man, for instance, would not like to practice breathing publicly in this country, because he would
- From time to time, there have been reformers in every religion who have stood against all symbols and rituals. But vain has been their opposi-
- It is vain to preach against the use of symbols, and why should we preach against them? There is no reason why man should not use symbols.
- In modern times, Christian clergymen have become a little kinder, and they allow that in the older religions, the different forms of worshi-
- A disciple went to his master and said to him, "Sir, I want religion." The master looked at the young man, and did not speak, but only smile

- The perfect man sees nothing but God. So we always worship our highest ideal, and when we have reached the point, when we love the ideal as

Taoism

- We look at it, and we do not see it, and we name it 'the Equable.' We listen to it, and we do not hear it, and we name it 'the Inaudible.'
- I know hereby what advantage belongs to doing nothing (with a purpose). There are few in the world who attain to the teaching without words
- He who devotes himself to learning (seeks) from day to day to increase (his knowledge); he who devotes himself to the Tao (seeks) from day
- the kingdom is made one's own (only) by freedom from action and purpose. How do I know that it is so? By these facts: In the kingdom the
- With these three qualities, it cannot be made the subject of description; and hence we blend them together and obtain The One. Its upper
- s lot; no fault greater than the wish to be getting. Therefore the sufficiency of contentment is an enduring and unchanging sufficiency.

Theresa of Avila

- There is nothing in all the world wherewith to buy the shedding abroad of Thy love in our heart, but our heart's love. If, however, we did
- At other times I find myself so arid that I am not able to form any distinct idea of God, nor can I put my soul into an attitude of prayer,
- Now this is the difference between natural and supernatural prayer: between mental and transcendental prayer. In ordinary prayer we more or
- It will be a great help towards this if we keep constantly in our thoughts the vanity of all things and the rapidity with which they pass
- he cares nothing if he loses everything, nor does he count this as loss.
- This house is another Heaven, if it be possible to have Heaven upon earth. Anyone whose sole pleasure lies in pleasing God and who cares no

Therese of Lisieux

- And just as Solomon, turning to all the works which his hand had wrought, and to the labours wherein he had laboured in vain, saw in all that
- ...I felt that one day I should be set free from this land of darkness. I believed it, not only because I had been told so by others, but
- How can it be said that it is more perfect to separate oneself from home and friends? Has anyone ever reproached brothers who fight side by
- And I should not suffer any disappointment, for when we expect nothing but suffering, then the least joy is a surprise; and later on suffer

- Yes, I know when I show charity to others, it is simply Jesus acting in me, and the more closely I am united to Him, the more dearly I loveâ€¦!
- When I recall these days of my noviciate I understand how far I was from perfection, and the memory of certain things makes me laugh...It mât€!

Thomas Keating

- To bring oneself to nothingâ€”no thingâ€”is to cease to identify with the tyranny of our emotional programs for happiness and the limitations oât€!
- The ultimate abandonment of oneâ€™s role is not to have a self as a fixed point of reference; it is the freedom to manifest God through oneâ€™sâ€¦!

Thomas Kempis

- If thou knewest the whole Bible, and the sayings of all the philosophers, what should all this profit thee without the love and grace of Goât€!
- Be not high-minded, but rather confess thine ignorance. Why desirest thou to lift thyself above another, when there are found many more leaât€!
- He is truly great who deemeth himself small, and counteth all height of honour as nothing. He is the truly wise man, who counteth all earthât€!
- Vain is the life of that man who putteth his trust in men or in any created Thing.
- Avoid as far as thou canst the tumult of men; for talk concerning worldly things, though it be innocently undertaken, is a hindrance, so quât€!
- It is good that we sometimes endure contradictions, and are hardly and unfairly judged, when we do and mean what is good. For these things â€!

Thomas Ligotti

- As history confirms, people will change their minds about almost anything, from which god they worship to how they style their hair. But whât€!
- One would think that neuroscientists and geneticists would have as much reason to head for the cliffs because little by little they have beât€!
- In experiencing the uncanny, there is a feeling of wrongness...Of course, our internal authority may itself be in the wrong, perhaps becausât€!
- One day those shoes on the floor of your clothes closet may attract your eye in a way they never have before. Somehow they have become abstât€!
- In perfect knowledge there is only perfect nothingness, which is perfectly painful if what you want is meaning in your life.
- It is all a vacuous affair with only a chemical prestige. Nothing is either good or bad, desirable or undesirable, or anything else except â€!

Thomas Merton

- The truly sacred attitude toward life is in no sense an escape from the sense of nothingness that assails us when we are left alone with ourselves!
- In order to meditate, I have to withdraw my mind from all that prevents me from attending to God present in my heart. This is impossible unless!
- We have to enter into our meditation with a realization of our spiritual poverty, our complete lack of the things we seek, and of our abjection!

Tolstoy

- Till I know the reasons for my own acts, I can do nothing, I cannot live.
- My life had come to a sudden stop. I was able to breathe, to eat, to drink, to sleep. I could not, indeed, help doing so; but there was no more!
- standing like a fool with but one thing clear to me that there was nothing in life, that there never was anything, and never will be.
- I was only astonished that this had not occurred to me before, from premises which had so long been known. Illness and death would come (invariably)!
- "What is the meaning of my life? It has none. Or what will come of my life? Nothing. Or why does all that exist, and why do I exist? Because!"
- What do we who love truth seek in life? In order to be free from the body and all the ills that accompany life in it. If so, then, how shall we!

William James

- "Whilst in this state of philosophic pessimism and general depression of spirits about my prospects, I went one evening into a dressing-room!"
- To prove this point, Tolstoy quotes the Buddha, Solomon, and Schopenhauer. And he finds only four ways in which men of his own class and so on!
- The method of averting one's attention from evil, and living simply in the light of good is splendid as long as it will work. It will work unless!
- Imagine the one thing that you value most in this world. Now, can you imagine that thing, the thing that you feel sustains your own existence!
- For Tolstoy's perceptions of evil appear within their sphere to have remained unmodified. His later works show him implacable to the whole!
- 'We would make known in our own persons the usefulness of rule, of discipline, of resignation and renunciation; we would teach the necessity!

William Lane Craig-

- The fate of the sons of men and the fate of beasts is the same. As one dies so dies the other; indeed, they all have the same breath and thus!
- Vanity of vanities! All is vanity
- Unfortunately, the mass of mankind do not realize this fact. They continue on as though nothing has changed. I'm reminded of Nietzsche's statement!

- Thus they yelled and laughed. Then, writes Nietzsche, the madman turned in their midst and pierced them with his eyes 'Whither is God?' he asked
- And this is just fooling ourselves. The point is this: if God does not exist, then life is objectively meaningless; but man cannot live without it
- Look at each of these. No Ultimate Meaning without Immortality and God If each individual person passes out of existence when he dies, then

Skepticism of Knowledge

Augustine

- And finding that Thou maddest them, they give not themselves up to Thee, to preserve what Thou maddest, nor sacrifice to Thee what they have
- ...those passages in scripture...I could see that they were to be resolved by the mysteries of spiritual interpretation.
- And when this power of reason within me also found that it was changeable, it raised itself up to its own intellectual principle, and withdrew
- For it was not salvation that he taught in rhetoric (why, then, should he shrink from naming your name before the sheep of the flock), and asked

Emile Cioran

- so you witnessed old age, pain, and death and told yourself that pleasure is an illusion and that the pleasure seekers do not understand that
- I am sorry sometimes that God no longer fills us with dread. If only we could feel again the primordial quiver of dread in front of the unknown
- our mode of believing. The most obscure mystical mumbo-jumbo is closer to God than the Summa Theologiae (symbolism, infinite/finite gap, death)

Ernest Becker

- But now we see the historical difference between the classical sinner and the modern neurotic: both of them experience the naturalness of human
- Finally, religion alone gives hope, because it holds open the dimension of the unknown and the unknowable, the fantastic mystery of creation
- "In lonely death. It is all right to be nothing vis-a-vis God, who alone can make it right in His unknown ways; it is another thing to be nothing"
- " (is this why the experience of Meaninglessness is stronger/more important than the Mystical experience, with Tillich, Vivekananda, Cioran, asked
- to do what religion has always asked: to believe in a justification for their lives that seems absurd. The neurotic knows better: he is the asked

Evelyn Underhill

- We begin, then, to ask what can be the nature of this One; and whence comes the persistent instinct whichâ€”receiving no encouragement from sâ€”!
- The great contemplatives, those destined to attain the full stature of the mystic, emerge from this period of destitution, however long andâ€”!
- the mystic poets, and all who shared in and were contented with the illuminated vision of reality. Those who go on are the great and strongâ€”!

GK Chesterton

- The Laws of Nature...We must answer that it is magic. It is not a "law," for we do not understand its general formula. It is not a necessitâ€”!
- s argument; we have at once the sense of it covering everything and the sense of it leaving everything out...His cosmos may be complete in â€”!

Jesus

- This is why I speak to them in parables, because seeing they do not see, and hearing they do not hear, nor do they understand.

Kierkegaard

- ...one might say perhaps that there lives not one single man who after all is not to some extent in despair, in whose inmost parts there doâ€”!
- s life is wasted who lived on, so deceived by the joys of life or by its sorrows that he never became eternally and decisively conscious ofâ€”!

Lev Shestov

- Lightning kills man, diseases torture him to death, other animals take away his food; all this is natural, all this is a part of order of tâ€”!

Martin Heidegger

- (Me: This seems to be in the context of finitude, man's 'normal' situation of ignoring/repressing his finitude, but the 'moment of vision' â€”!
- come up.â€” (this seems to be the reason why most scientists do not understand the consequences of their theories, let alone world-views. Theâ€”!
- is indefinite, unknown, etc., and this call is brought on, or

Meister Eckhart

- He is the end of all creation. This end is concealed in the darkness of the everlasting Godhead, and is unknown, and never was known, and nâ€”!
- s love.â€” (Kierkegaard) â€œHe is the end of all creation. This end is concealed in the darkness of the everlasting Godhead, and is unknown, anâ€”!

Miguel de Unamuno

- Like Pascal, I do not understand those who assert that they care not a farthing for these things, and this indifference " in a matter that

Nietzsche

- Do not let yourself be deceived: great intellects are sceptical. Zarathustra is a sceptic. The strength, the freedom which proceed from int

Pascal

- Whatever condition we picture to ourselves, if we muster all the good things which it is possible to possess, royalty is the finest positio
- He who does not see the vanity of the world is himself very vain. Indeed who do not see it but youths who are absorbed in fame, diversion,
- religious experience) He who does not see the vanity of the world is himself very vain. Indeed who do not see it but youths who are absorb

Plato /Socrates

- Then I knew that not by wisdom do poets write poetry, but by a sort of genius and inspiration; they are like diviners or soothsayers who
- ...the philosopher's mission of searching into myself and other men, I were to desert my post through fear of death, or any other fear; tha
-) I found that the men most in repute were all but the most foolish; and that others less esteemed were really wiser and better. Then I

Schopenhauer

- ...the misery of boredom...boredom is a form of suffering unknown to brutes.
- s booth at a fair, and witnesses the performance twice or thrice in succession. The tricks were meant to be seen only once; and when they a

Taoism

- We look at it, and we do not see it, and we name it 'the Equable.' We listen to it, and we do not hear it, and we name it 'the Inaudible.'
- s conduct will to evil change. Therefore the sage seeks to satisfy (the craving of) the belly, and not the (insatiable longing of the) eyes
- With these three qualities, it cannot be made the subject of description; and hence we blend them together and obtain The One. Its upper pa

Theresa of Avila

- Oh, if we religious understood what harm we get from having so much to do with our relatives, how we should shun them! do not see what pleaâ€
- s conception of â€œhumilityâ€ is extremely strict. â€œThere is nothing in all the world wherewith to buy the shedding abroad of Thy love in our â€

Therese of Lisieux

- Here, I am loved by you and all the Sisters, and this love is very sweet to me, and I dream of a convent where I should be unknown, where Iâ€
- â€œNo doubt, dear Mother, you will think I exaggerate somewhat the night of my soul. If you judge by the poems I have composed this year, it â€

Thomas Kempis

- Be not high-minded, but rather confess thine ignorance. Why desirest thou to lift thyself above another, when there are found many more leaâ€
- It is better to be unknown and take heed to oneself than to neglect oneself and work wonders. It is praiseworthy for a religious man to go â€
- Grant that I may die to all worldly things, and for Thy sake love to be despised and unknown in this world.
- Therefore, whatsoever seemeth to thee desirable, thou must always desire and seek after it with the fear of God and humility of heart, and â€
- s eyes contemptible; but in the sight of God they were precious and beloved.â€ â€œBe thou never without something to do; be reading, or writinâ€
- Lord, thou knowest what is best; let this or that be, according as Thou wilt.â€ (Vivekananda and Karma Yoga) â€œGrant that I may die to all woâ€

Tolstoy

- I once thought that if a foreign invasion occurred, or even if evil-minded persons attacked me, and I did not defend myself, I should be roâ€

Void/Nothingness

A. W. Tozer

- He had concentrated his all in the person of his dear son, and God had taken it from him. God could have begun out on the margin of Abrahamâ€
- ...the rending of the veil...is nothing pleasant...To tear it away is to injure us, to hurt us and make us bleed. To say otherwise is to maâ€
- In the world of men we find nothing approaching the virtues of which Jesus spoke in the opening words of the famous Sermon on the Mount. Inâ€
- The labor of self-love is a heavy one indeed. Think for yourself whether much of your sorrow has not arisen from someone speaking slightingâ€

- s life and worked inward to the center; He chose rather to cut quickly to the heart and have it over in one sharp act of separation. In deaâ€¹

Albert Camus

- Does not the failure reveal, beyond any possible explanation and interpretation, not the absence but the existence of transcendence?" That â€¹
- Nothing more profound, for example, than Kierkegaard's view according to which despair is not a fact but a state: the very state of sin. Foâ€¹
- Kierkegaard may shout in warning: "If man had no eternal consciousness, if, at the bottom of everything, there were merely a wild, seethingâ€¹
- The absurd man thus catches sight of a burning and frigid, transparent and limited universe in which nothing is possible but everything is â€¹
- Thus the absurd becomes god (in the broadest meaning of this word) and that inability to understand becomes the existence that illuminates â€¹
- s scenes, with that lucidity imposed on me by the pursuit of a science, I must sacrifice everything to these certainties and I must see theâ€¹

Aldous Huxley

- As recently as three hundred years ago an expression of thoroughgoing world denial and even world condemnation was both orthodox and compreâ€¹
- The outer world is what we wake up to every morning of our lives, is the place where, willy-nilly, we must try to make our living. In the iâ€¹
- ...I found myself all at once on the brink of panic. This, I suddenly felt, was going too far. Too far, even though the going was into inteâ€¹
- If men and women torment their bodies, it is not only because they hope in this way to atone for past sins and avoid future punishments; itâ€¹
- The best that can be said for ritualistic legalism is that it improves conduct. It does little, however, to alter character and nothing of â€¹
- In statements such as Eckhart's, God is equated with nothing.

Augustine

- How wretched was it! and Thou didst irritate the feeling of its wound, that forsaking all else, it might be converted unto Thee, who art abâ€¹
- And when this power of reason within me also found that it was changeable, it raised itself up to its own intellectual principle, and withdâ€¹
- ...I was so tightly held, and from the slavery of worldly business. With increasing anxiety I was going about my usual affairs, and daily sâ€¹
- For he saw that the causes of things were sought for by them,--which causes he believed to be ultimately reducible to nothing else than theâ€¹

- For it was not salvation that he taught in rhetoric (why, then, should he shrink from naming your name before the sheep of the flock), and â€
- s reading of the Bible during his experience- â€œNot in rioting and drunkenness, not in chambering and wantonness, not in strife and envying,â€

Bertrand Russell

- And Man said: â€˜There is a hidden purpose, could we but fathom it, and the purpose is good; for we must reverence something, and in the visiâ€
- In the spectacle of Death, in the endurance of intolerable pain, and in the irrevocableness of a vanished past, there is a sacredness, an oâ€
- To abandon the struggle for private happiness, to expel all eagerness of temporary desire, to burn with passion for eternal thingsâ€˜ this is â€
- Such, in outline, but even more purposeless, more void of meaning, is the world which Science presents for our belief. Amid such a world, iâ€

Buddhism

- my fear of birth, old age, disease, and death, has led me to disobey, and disregard his extreme kindness. Whoever neglects right consideratâ€
- the appearance of lustful desire; the wise man will have nothing to do with it; he would rather throw his body into the water or fire, or câ€
- I desire to get rid of birth, old age, and death, with body restrained, to beg my food; with appetites moderated, to keep in my retreat; anâ€
- ...whilst in that state of abstraction rising higher, perceiving there is a place beyond any bodily condition, adding still and perseveringâ€
- â€œAbsence, extinction, and unoccupancy--these are not the Buddhist conception of emptiness. Buddhists' Emptiness is not on the plane of relaâ€
- s life; hearing of my father, the king, and his grief, my heart is affected with increased love; but yet, all is like the fancy of a dream,â€

Ecclesiastes

- ...the eye is not satisfied with seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing. What has been is what will be, and what has been done is what wilâ€
- So I became great and I surpassed all who were before me in Jerusalem. Also my I wisdom remained with me. And whatever my eyes desired I diâ€

Edgar Saltus

- He was not much over twenty before excessive study had well-nigh ruined such health as he once possessed. The slightest application was weaâ€
- Leopardi at that time was in his twenty-seventh year, and the task to which he then devoted himself was, he said, to be the sad ending of aâ€

- The Buddhist believes that the soul migrates until Nirvāṇa is attained, and that in the preparation for this state, which is the death of Dâ€
- ...any man who has begun to dislike the propinquity of the average, and to feel that where the crowd find amusement there will be nothing bâ€
- To all this advanced pessimism has a ready answer: first, there can be no morality, for where there is no body and no property it is impossâ€
- To sum up, then, what has gone before, the modern pessimist is a Buddhist who has strayed from the Orient, and who in his exodus has left bâ€

Emile Cioran

- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreaâ€
- the most terrifying intensification bursts into nothingness. you grow inside, you dilate madly until there are no boundaries left, you reacâ€
- at the edge of life everything is an occasion for death...every experience is in this case a leap into nothingness.
- the passion for the absurd. there are no arguments. Can anyone who has reached the limit bother with arguments, causes, effects, moral consâ€
- i feel i must burst because of all that life offers me and because of the prospect of death. i feel that i am dying of solitude, of love, oâ€
- i live because the mountains do not laugh and the worms do not sing. the passion for the absurd can grow only in a man who has exhausted evâ€

Ernest Becker

- Mans body is a problem to him that has to be explained. Not only his body is strange, but also its inner landscape, the memories and dreamsâ€
- This despair he avoids by building defenses; and these defenses allow him to feel a basic sense of self-worth, of meaningfulness, of power.â€
- Neurosis is another word for describing a complicated technique for avoiding misery, but reality is the misery.
- We see again confirmed the point of view that a persons character is a defense against despair, an attempt to avoid insanity because of theâ€
- crazy": he is not in anythingâ€™s world. (Ha!) â€œThe irony of mans condition is that the deepest need is to be free of the anxiety of death â€
- ...the depressed person avoids the possibility of independence and more life precisely because these are what threaten him with destructionâ€

Evelyn Underhill

- Those who are temperamentally inclined to credulity may become naturalists, and persuade themselves to believe in the reality of the sense â€

- Nothing can be more certain than that man is not so content. He has been called by utilitarian philosophers a tool-making animal—the highest!
- Why, after all, take as our standard a material world whose existence is affirmed by nothing more trustworthy than the sense-impressions of it!
- ...you will find it impossible to prove that the world as seen by the mystics, "unimaginable, formless, dark with excess of bright," is less!
- "The intellect by itself moves nothing,
- In the mystic the dominant idea is a great one: so great in fact, that when it is received in its completeness by the human consciousness, it!

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- And indeed the Christian is, in a certain sense—in an ultimate sense—a "Nihilist"; for to him, in the end, the world is nothing, and God is!
- To him who lives in Christ, of course, many of the goods of this world may be given back, and he may enjoy them even while realizing their is!
- Such is the Nihilist universe, in which there is neither up nor down, right nor wrong, true nor false, because there is no longer any point!
- ...the universality of faith, seeing it as underlying all human activity and knowledge; and we have seen that faith, if it is not to fall, is!
- This ultimate truth, whether it be conceived as the Christian God or simply as the ultimate coherence of things, is a metaphysical first principle!
- The atheist arguments against such a god are as irrefutable as they are irrelevant; for such a god is, in fact, the same as no god at all. is!

GK Chesterton

- If a man says that extinction is better than existence or blank existence better than variety and adventure, then he is not one of the ordinary!
- ...the chief mark and element of insanity; we may say in summary that it is reason used without root, reason in the void.
- But the modern critics of religious authority are like men who should attack the police without ever having heard of burglars. For there is!
- ...the philosophies of Schopenhauer and Tolstoy, Nietzsche and Shaw, as clearly as an inevitable railway smash could be seen from a balloon!
- Joan of Arc was not stuck at the cross-roads, either by rejecting all the paths like Tolstoy, or by accepting them all like Nietzsche. She is!
- I had often called myself an optimist, to avoid the too evident blasphemy of pessimism. But all the optimism of the age had been false and is!

Herman Tjønnessen

- ...cognitive...empathetic 'disintegrity' ...to hold cognitively incompatible views or positions...to prevent knowledge from penetrating 'volâ€'
- Ordinary language...it lulls us into this platitudinal world of small-talk where everything is taken for granted: life, death, the world, â€'
- One of the simplest forms of suffocation (offering happiness and peace of mind through the most comfortable evasions and illusions) consistâ€'
- If a student has difficulties in getting to the university because of their fear of stepping on cracks in the pavement, this is not a problâ€'
- The existentialists, on the other hand, find a life lived in utter awareness of man's cosmic conditions to be a life void of human dignity,â€'
- t have a dime for the jukebox; the room is painfully satiated with embarrassing silence. Instantly and unexpectedly he is struck by an execâ€'

Hinduism

- 5. If a man performs his sacred works when these flames are shining, and the oblations follow at the right time, then they lead him as sun-â€'

Jesus

- Godliness with contentment is great gain. For we brought nothing into this world, and it is certain we can carry nothing out. And having foâ€'

John Shelby Spong

- Many forms of religion are little more than cultural manifestations of the fear of nothingness. That is why people become hysterical when tâ€'

Kierkegaard

- So it is that Christianity has taught the Christian to think dauntlessly of everything earthly and worldly, including death. It is almost â€'
- This view will doubtless seem to many a paradox, an exaggeration, and a gloomy and depressing view at that. Yet it is nothing of the sort. â€'
- But in spite of the fact that a man has become fantastic in this fashion, he may nevertheless (although most commonly it becomes manifest) â€'
- So the despairing self is constantly building nothing but castles in the air, it fights only in the air. All these experimented virtues makâ€'
- Despair over the earthly or over something earthly is the commonest sort of despair, especially in the second form of immediacy with a quanâ€'
- Humanly speaking his destruction is the most certain of all things -- and the despair in his soul fights desperately to get leave to despairâ€'

Lev Shestov

- Where Nietzsche lacks faith, Tolstoy also lacks faith. But Nietzsche does not hide this (he hides other things), while Tolstoy believes that
- Has Tolstoy the right to demand of us that we, without doubting the good faith and sincerity of his words, must accept his proclamation that
- In the words of Zarathustra quoted above, a stage of development is formulated which has become for modern man unavoidable. It is no longer
- I repeat, it is an error to think that Nietzsche's experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it occurs perhaps much more
- Almost everything about which Nietzsche wrote is absolutely removed from the ordinary ideas of human thought and from the experience of the
- He clearly had the right to consider himself "beyond good and evil," irrespective of the fact that he knew how necessary and useful the con

Martin Heidegger

- The moment of vision, however, brings existence into the Situation and discloses the authentic 'there'." (Me: This seems to be in the conte
- In particular, that in the face of which one has anxiety is not encountered as something definite with which one can concern oneself; the th
- Anxiety liberates him from possibilities which 'count for nothing', and lets him become free for those which are authentic.
- indifference' is not the same as embracing death and existence. end of pg. 395-396- 'As the Present leaps away' even if one has experience
- Dasein is always 'there'- that is to say, in that public disclosedness of Being-with-one-another where the loudest idle talk and the most i
- We miss a 'positive' content in that which is called, because we expect to be told something currently useful about assured possibilities o

Martin Luther

- God forbid! Even if God were to offer me paradise in order that I might last forty more years in this life, I wouldn't want it. I'd rather
- Therefore, it is not irreligious, curious, or superfluous, but essentially wholesome and necessary, for a Christian to know, whether or not
- You make the power of "Free-will" to be "that certain small degree of power, which, without the grace of God, is utterly ineffective." Do y
- For in this way, I will make it appear, that a stone, or a log of wood has "Freewill," because it can go upwards and downwards; although, b
- free will since anything to do with free will is necessarily Earthly, and God, or the Other, is not only valuable, but the Ground of all V
- It is ineffective (you say) and can do nothing of good...without the grace of God, it is ineffective. Great Earthly/Other distinction/conc

Meister Eckhart

- Only he knows God who recognizes that all creatures are nothingness.
- The second means of attraction which he used is Emptiness...Jesus Christ made Himself empty that he might wisely draw all things to Himself.
- God has remained from everlasting in immovable sanctity, and still remains so. When He created heaven and earth and all creatures, His sanctity!
- Here, thou shouldest know that in every man are two kinds of men, the outer and the inner man. Every man, who loves God, only uses his outer!
- "What is the object of this immovable sanctity?" I answer, "Nothing" — "For this we may take the following illustration: if we bake in one oven!"
- The question arises: But what then does the sanctified heart pray for? I answer that when truly sanctified, it prays for nothing, for whose!

Miguel de Molinos

- The way to attain that high state of a Mind reformed, whereby a man immediately gets to the greatest Good, to our first Original, and to that!
- But the happy Soul which is gotten to this holy hatred of it self, lives overwhelmed, drowned and swallowed up in the depth of its own Nothing!
- The Senses are not capable of divine Blessings; hence if thou would be Happy and Wise; be Silent and Believe; Suffer and have Patience; be —!
- Think not that when thou art dry and drowsy in the presence of God, with faith and silence, that thou do'st nothing, that thou lovest time!
- But fear not: all this is necessary for purging thy Soul, and making it know its own misery, and sensibly perceive the annihilation of all —!
- Here thou art to shut up the Senses, trusting God with all the care of thy Welfare, and minding nothing of the affairs this Life.

Miguel de Unamuno

- If consciousness is, as some inhuman thinker has said, nothing more than a flash of light between two eternities of darkness, then there is —!
- All knowledge has an ultimate object. Knowledge for the sake of knowledge is, say what you will, nothing but a dismal begging of the question!
- Science exists only in personal consciousness and thanks to it; astronomy, mathematics, have no other reality than that which they possess —!
- We personalize the All in order to save ourselves from Nothingness; and the only mystery really mysterious is the mystery of suffering. Suffer!
- Although this meditation upon mortality may soon induce in us a sense of anguish, it fortifies us in the end. Retire, reader, into yourself!
- Why do I wish to know whence I come and whither I go, whence comes and whither goes everything that environs me, and what is the meaning of —!

Mitchell Heisman

- If reason is incapable of deducing ultimate, nonarbitrary human ends, and nothing can be judged as ultimately more important than anything else!
- The implications of life's meaninglessness have not been elicited with sufficient ruthlessness. My methodology is honesty to the point of amorality!
- When all choices are equal, equality is compatible with total randomness. If all choices are equal, then the choice of death is equal to that of life!
- What is closest to total indifference is to be dead. If an observer hypothesizes death then, from that perspective, the observer has no vested interest in life!
- When all choices are equal, equality is compatible with total randomness. If all choices are equal, then the choice of death is equal to that of life!
- But, most end up with worldly conclusions which do not go far enough, the end is the self-negation of the self, in order to embrace or attempt amorality!

Montaigne

- Cicero says- "that to study philosophy is nothing but to prepare one's self to die." -"how much I have less to do with the commodities of life!"
- Besides, live as long as you can, you shall by that nothing shorten the space you are to be dead; 'tis all to no purpose; you shall be everlastingly!
- ...how is it possible a man should disengage himself from the thought of death, or avoid fancying that it has us every moment by the throat?
- that to study philosophy is nothing but to prepare one's self to die.
- s self to die." -"how much I have less to do with the commodities of life, by reason that I begin to lose the use and pleasure of them, by the way!"

Nietzsche

- What is your greatest experience? It is the hour of the great contempt. The hour in which even your happiness becomes repulsive to you, and you are sick of it!
- It was morality that protected life against despair and the leap into nothing.
- We have killed him (God), you and I! We are all his murderers! But how have we done it? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us the strength?
- But the castration, against all nature, of such a god, making him a god of goodness alone, would be contrary to human inclination. Mankind is not godlike!
- The Christian concept of a god--the god as the patron of the sick, the god as a spinner of cobwebs, the god as a spirit--is one of the most degenerate!
- The two physiological facts upon which it grounds itself and upon which it bestows its chief attention are: first, an excessive sensitivity to pain!

Pascal

- We do not require great education of the mind to understand that here is no real and lasting satisfaction; that our pleasures are only vaniâ€'
- Let him see therein an infinity of universes, each of which has its firmament, its planets, its earth, in the same proportion as in the visâ€'
- Let us then take our compass; we are something, and we are not everything. The nature of our existence hides from us the knowledge of firstâ€'
- This is our true state; this is what makes us incapable of certain knowledge and of absolute ignorance. We sail within a vast sphere, ever â€'
- Nothing is so insufferable to man as to be completely at rest, without passions, without business, without diversion, without study. He theâ€'
- Whatever condition we picture to ourselves, if we muster all the good things which it is possible to possess, royalty is the finest positioâ€'

Paul Tillich

- History has shown this weakness and final emptiness of all merely secular cultures.
- The danger of this method, of course, is that the faith, meditated in education, will remain a traditional attitude and never break throughâ€'
- , Vivekananda saying nothing will make us ultimately content in this world of Maya) Faith- â€œ...is the passion for the infinite.â€ Ultimate Câ€'

Peter Zappfe

- Only a limited part of humanity can make do with mere â€˜changesâ€™™, whether in work, social life, or entertainment. The cultured person demandâ€'
- If we continue these considerations to the bitter end, then the conclusion is not in doubt. As long as humankind recklessly proceeds in theâ€'

Plato /Socrates

- But the simple truth is, O Athenians, that I have nothing to do with physical speculations.
- When I began to talk with him, I could not help thinking that he was not really wise, although he was thought wise by many, and still wiserâ€'
- At last I went to the artisans. I was conscious that I knew nothing at all, as I may say, and I was sure that they knew many fine things; â€'
- This inquisition has led to my having many enemies of the worst and most dangerous kind, and has given occasion also to many calumnies. Andâ€'
- For I do nothing but go about persuading you all, old and young alike, not to take thought for your persons or your properties, but first â€'
- Let us reflect in another way, and we shall see that there is great reason to hope that death is a good; for one of two thingsâ€œeither deathâ€'

Pseudo-Dionysius

- Therewith, they learn that It is the Cause of all things and yet Itself is nothing, because It super-essentially transcends them all.
- “Therewith, they learn that It is the Cause of all things and yet Itself is nothing, because It super-essentially transcends them all.”

Schopenhauer

- The crowd of miserable wretches whose one aim in life is to fill their purses but never to put anything into their heads, offers a singular
- This is the realm of finality; and its opposite would be an infinite existence, exposed to no attack from without, and needing nothing to
- This is direct proof that existence has no real value in itself; for what is boredom but the feeling of the emptiness of life?
- Were it of any value in itself, anything unconditioned and absolute, it could not thus end in mere nothing.
- s booth at a fair, and witnesses the performance twice or thrice in succession. The tricks were meant to be seen only once; and when they

St. John of the Cross

- The doctrine of Christ which He came into the world to teach, is contempt of all things, that we may thereby have power to receive the reward
- The whole creation (all wisdom, sweetness, goodness, liberty, riches, etc.), compared with the infinite Being of God, is nothing; and so the
- The earth “void and nothing,” signifies that the earth and all it contains are nothing, and the heavens without light, that all the lights
- The whole creation, compared with the infinite Being of God, is nothing; and so the soul whose affections are set on created things is nothing
- This God himself will do during the observance of the first two commandments; He will change them from old into new, by infusing into the
- I mean ways of understanding, perceiving, or feeling, though it has all ways at the same time, as one who, possessing nothing, yet possesses

Swami Vivekananda

- The second is the fear of persecution. A man, for instance, would not like to practice breathing publicly in this country, because he would
- In modern times, Christian clergymen have become a little kinder, and they allow that in the older religions, the different forms of worship
- A disciple went to his master and said to him, "Sir, I want religion." The master looked at the young man, and did not speak, but only smiled
- The perfect man sees nothing but God. So we always worship our highest ideal, and when we have reached the point, when we love the ideal as

- are wrong. Therefore, we should get rid of these childish notions. We should get beyond the prattle of men who think that religion is mere
- , as Vivekananda defines him, that does not realize the truths of religion) "Who wants God? That is the question. Do you think that all thi

Taoism

- The Tao is (like) the emptiness of a vessel; and in our employment of it we must be on our guard against all fulness. How deep and unfathom
- We look at it, and we do not see it, and we name it 'the Equable.' We listen to it, and we do not hear it, and we name it 'the Inaudible.'
- I know hereby what advantage belongs to doing nothing (with a purpose). There are few in the world who attain to the teaching without words
- He who devotes himself to learning (seeks) from day to day to increase (his knowledge); he who devotes himself to the Tao (seeks) from day
- the kingdom is made one's own (only) by freedom from action and purpose. How do I know that it is so? By these facts: "In the kingdom the m
- When the people do not fear what they ought to fear, that which is their great dread will come on them. Let them not thoughtlessly indulge

Theresa of Avila

- There is nothing in all the world wherewith to buy the shedding abroad of Thy love in our heart, but our heart's love. If, however, we did
- At other times I find myself so arid that I am not able to form any distinct idea of God, nor can I put my soul into an attitude of prayer,
- Now this is the difference between natural and supernatural prayer: between mental and transcendental prayer. In ordinary prayer we more or
- he cares nothing if he loses everything, nor does he count this as loss.
- This house is another Heaven, if it be possible to have Heaven upon earth. Anyone whose sole pleasure lies in pleasing God and who cares no
- Why, then, my sisters, do we not show Him love in so far as we can? Consider what a wonderful exchange it is if we give Him our love and re

Therese of Lisieux

- And just as Solomon, turning to all the works which his hand had wrought, and to the labours wherein he had laboured in vain, saw in all th
- ...I felt that one day I should be set free from this land of darkness. I believed it, not only because I had been told so by others, but m
- How can it be said that it is more perfect to separate oneself from home and friends? Has anyone ever reproached brothers who fight side by

- And I should not suffer any disappointment, for when we expect nothing but suffering, then the least joy is a surprise; and later on sufferâ€¦!
- There are, of course, no enemies in the Carmel; but, after all, we have our natural likes and dislikes. We may feel drawn towards one Sisteâ€¦!
- When I recall these days of my noviciate I understand how far I was from perfection, and the memory of certain things makes me laugh...It mâtâ€¦!

Thomas Keating

- To bring oneself to nothingâ€”no thingâ€”is to cease to identify with the tyranny of our emotional programs for happiness and the limitations oâ€¦!
- The ultimate abandonment of oneâ€™s role is not to have a self as a fixed point of reference; it is the freedom to manifest God through oneâ€™sâ€¦!

Thomas Kempis

- Be not high-minded, but rather confess thine ignorance. Why desirest thou to lift thyself above another, when there are found many more leaâ€¦!
- He is truly great who deemeth himself small, and counteth all height of honour as nothing. He is the truly wise man, who counteth all earthâ€¦!
- Avoid as far as thou canst the tumult of men; for talk concerning worldly things, though it be innocently undertaken, is a hindrance, so quâ€¦!
- O how many and grievous tribulations did the Apostles, Martyrs, Confessors, Virgins, endure; and all others who would walk in the footstepsâ€¦!
- If thou withdraw thyself from trifling conversation and idle goings about, as well as from novelties and gossip, thou shalt find thy time sâ€¦!
- There are many foolish and unstable men who say, "See what a prosperous life that man hath, how rich and how great he is, how powerful, howâ€¦!"

Thomas Ligotti

- As history confirms, people will change their minds about almost anything, from which god they worship to how they style their hair. But whâ€¦!
- One would think that neuroscientists and geneticists would have as much reason to head for the cliffs because little by little they have beâ€¦!
- In experiencing the uncanny, there is a feeling of wrongness...Of course, our internal authority may itself be in the wrong, perhaps becausâ€¦!
- One day those shoes on the floor of your clothes closet may attract your eye in a way they never have before. Somehow they have become abstâ€¦!
- In perfect knowledge there is only perfect nothingness, which is perfectly painful if what you want is meaning in your life.
- It is all a vacuous affair with only a chemical prestige. Nothing is either good or bad, desirable or undesirable, or anything else except â€¦!

Thomas Merton

- The truly sacred attitude toward life is in no sense an escape from the sense of nothingness that assails us when we are left alone with ourselves!
- We have to enter into our meditation with a realization of our spiritual poverty, our complete lack of the things we seek, and of our abjection!

Tolstoy

- Till I know the reasons for my own acts, I can do nothing, I cannot live.
- My life had come to a sudden stop. I was able to breathe, to eat, to drink, to sleep. I could not, indeed, help doing so; but there was no help!
- ...I hid away a cord, to avoid being tempted to hang myself by it to one of the pegs between the cupboards of my study, where I undressed!
- standing like a fool with but one thing clear to me that there was nothing in life, that there never was anything, and never will be.
- I was only astonished that this had not occurred to me before, from premises which had so long been known. Illness and death would come (inevitably)!
- "What is the meaning of my life? It has none. Or what will come of my life? Nothing. Or why does all that is exist, and why do I exist? Because!"

William James

- "Whilst in this state of philosophic pessimism and general depression of spirits about my prospects, I went one evening into a dressing-room!"
- To prove this point, Tolstoy quotes the Buddha, Solomon, and Schopenhauer. And he finds only four ways in which men of his own class and so!
- The method of averting one's attention from evil, and living simply in the light of good is splendid as long as it will work. It will work!
- Imagine the one thing that you value most in this world. Now, can you imagine that thing, the thing that you feel sustains your own existence!
- Whilst in this state of philosophic pessimism and general depression of spirits about my prospects, I went one evening into a dressing-room!
- s Other, not good. Which is why Augustine says that Evil is negative in existence since evil is simply a lack of goodness. "Let us see rather!"

William Lane Craig-

- Unfortunately, the mass of mankind do not realize this fact. They continue on as though nothing has changed. I'm reminded of Nietzsche's statement!
- Thus they yelled and laughed. Then, writes Nietzsche, the madman turned in their midst and pierced them with his eyes 'Whither is God?' he asked!

- s look at each of these. No Ultimate Meaning without Immortality and God If each individual person passes out of existence when he dies, thâ€™
- I shall tell you. We have killed himâ€™”you and I. All of us are his murderers. But how have we done this? How were we able to drink up the seâ€™
- s pretend the universe has meaning.” And this is just fooling ourselves. The point is this: if God does not exist, then life is objectivelyâ€™

Temporality/Impermanence

Aldous Huxley

- How could one reconcile this timeless bliss of seeing as one ought to see with the temporal duties of doing what one ought to do and feelinâ€™
- The saint is one who knows that every moment of our human life is a moment of crisis; for at every moment we are called upon to make an allâ€™
- To sum up, that mortification is the best which results in the elimination of self-will, self-interest, self-centered thinking, wishing andâ€™
- ...an immense increase in technical and governmental efficiency and an immense increase in scientific knowledge- each of them a result of tâ€™
- to the temporal success or failure of the cause to which one has devoted one

Angela of Foligno

- He deigned to be poor in all the temporal things of this world. Thus did He own neither land, nor vineyard, nor garden, nor other possessioâ€™

Augustine

- ...wretched is every soul bound by the friendship of perishable things.
- Thus also, when, above, eternity delights us (attracts us from above), and the pleasure of temporal good (earthly delight) holds us down beâ€™

Bertrand Russell

- Brief and powerless is Manâ€™™s life; on him and all his race the slow, sure doom falls pitiless and dark. Blind to good and evil, reckless ofâ€™

Emile Cioran

- those who try to eliminate the fear of death through artificial reasoning are totally mistaken, because it is impossible to cancel an organâ€™
- the experience of eternity therefore depends on intensity of subjective feeling, and the way to eternity is to transcend the temporal...eveâ€™
- time with its long train of individual moments is, if not unreal, irrelevant...without temporality, life loses its dramatic character...theâ€™

- why not abandon this futile work and begin anew without repeating the same wasteful mistake? is subjective consciousness of eternity not enough?
- We can conceive of eternity only by eliminating all the perishable, all that counts for us. Eternity is absence, being that fills none of it.
- The failed mystic is the one who cannot cast off all temporal ties.

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- Everything in this life passes away – only God remains, only He is worth struggling towards. We have a choice: to follow the way of this world.

Hinduism

- 6. 'That which cannot be seen, nor seized, which has no family and no caste, no eyes nor ears, no hands nor feet, the eternal, the omnipresent.
- 5. If a man performs his sacred works when these flames are shining, and the oblations follow at the right time, then they lead him as sun.

Jesus

- Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on.

Kierkegaard

- But in spite of the fact that a man has become fantastic in this fashion, he may nevertheless (although most commonly it becomes manifest) –
- And thus it is precisely with the despair of finitude. In spite of the fact that a man is in despair he can perfectly well live on in the –
- Oh, you sufferer, whoever you may be, will you then with doubleness of mind seek the relief that temporal existence can give, the relief that –
- There is the change of the perishable nature when the sensual man must step aside, when dancing and the tumult of the whirling senses are over.
- For the wish is the sufferer's connection with a happier temporal existence (faith and hope are related to the Eternal through the will); and
- But with love it is most joyous of all. For there is a love, that blazes up and is forgotten; there is a love that unites and divides – a love.

Lev Shestov

- No one in the world can do anything against this age-old "law" of being established by almighty Nothingness: all are powerless, as Søren Kierkegaard
- of being established by almighty Nothingness: all are powerless, as Søren Kierkegaard was powerless – only no one recognizes or feels horror –

Martin Heidegger

- The moment of vision, however, brings existence into the Situation and discloses the authentic 'there'." (Me: This seems to be in the conteâ€'
- Anxiety discloses an insignificance of the world; and this insignificance reveals the nullity of that with which one can concern oneself- oâ€'
- (Me: This seems to be in the context of finitude, man's 'normal' situation of ignoring/repressing his finitude, but the 'moment of vision' â€'
- ecstático-temporal relation to the thrown ground of itself

Martin Luther

- But how much better is it to lose the whole world, than to lose God the Creator of the world, who can create innumerable worlds again, and â€'

Meister Eckhart

- The moral task of man is a process of spiritualization. All creatures are go-betweens, and we are placed in time that by diligence in spiriâ€'
- The merely temporal life in itself is a negation of real being, because it depends on itself and not on the deepest foundation of life; theâ€'
- s good works and prayers, as though they had accomplished none, and He is by those means no more favourably inclined towards men than if thâ€'

Miguel de Unamuno

- What is certain is that for thinking believers to-day, faith is, before all and above all, wishing that God may exist.
- The consciousness that everything passes away, that we ourselves pass away, and that everything that is ours and everything that environs uâ€'
- Miguel de Molinos, who said in his Guia Espiritual 1 that 'he who would attain to the mystical science must abandon and be detached from fiâ€'
- And this is truth. For in his head the righteous man may say to himself, God does not exist! But only the wicked can say it in his heart. Nâ€'

Mitchell Heisman

- paragraph coming from someone who is cracking under the pressure of existence, of being. Nihilism, or naturalism vs theism, material vs nonâ€'

Nietzsche

- If I understand anything at all about this great symbolist, it is this: that he regarded only subjective realities as realities, as "truthsâ€'

- Interpretation. -All the visions, fears, exhaustions and delights of the saint are well known symptoms of sickness, which in him, owing to

St. John of the Cross

- I say, then, that the soul, to be rightly guided by faith to this estate, must be in darkness, not only as to that part thereof the sensual
- The fourth kind of pain is caused in the soul by another excellence of this dark contemplation, which is its majesty and greatness, from which
- much less can it attend to other things and affairs which are temporal. Not only so, but it has likewise such distractions and times of such

Thomas Kempis

- There are many foolish and unstable men who say, "See what a prosperous life that man hath, how rich and how great he is, how powerful, how
- Very quickly will there be an end of thee here; take heed therefore how it will be with thee in another world. To-day man is, and to-morrow
- Then thou shalt make great progress if thou keep thyself free from all temporal care. Thou shalt lamentably fall away if thou set a value upon
- Let temporal things be in the use, eternal things in the desire. Thou canst not be satisfied with any temporal good, for thou wast not created
- "My Son! I came down from heaven for thy salvation; I took upon Me thy miseries not of necessity, but drawn by love that thou mightest learn
- "Who art thou, that thou shouldst be afraid of a man that shall die? To-day he is, and to-morrow his place is not found. Fear God and thou

Tolstoy

- I speak of men of our class, of men who are true to themselves, and not of those who make of religion a means of obtaining some temporal advantage
- When such an instance does occur, it is not inspired by a desire to make life more simple, but to amass money and make it more sure. Each
- I was only astonished that this had not occurred to me before, from premises which had so long been known. Illness and death would come (in
- The dulness of their imagination enables these men to forget what destroyed the peace of Buddha, the inevitable sickness, old age, and death
- If he had lived in our day, in Russia, he would have said: "Think you that those who perished in the circus at Berditchef or on the slopes
- His burden must be got rid of. The dulness of their imagination enables these men to forget what destroyed the peace of Buddha, the inevitable

Self-Abnegation/Asceticism

Aldous Huxley

- We should talk less and draw more. I personally should like to renounce speech altogether and, like organic Nature, communicate everything
- Until we put an end to particular attachments, there can be no love of God with the whole heart, mind and strength and no universal charity
- ...the critical philosophy must mortify his commonsense...
- sake. Hence the hard sayings of the Gospels about the need to renounce exclusive family ties. Mortification is painful...This fact of

Emile Cioran

- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreams
- nothing is important. how important can it be that i suffer and think? My presence in this world will disturb a few tranquil lives and will
- spirit in life is an anomaly. i have renounced so much, why should i not renounce spirit as well? but besides being an illness of life, is
- so you witnessed old age, pain, and death and told yourself that pleasure is an illusion and that the pleasure seekers do not understand that
- then you will think it useless to express an opinion, to take a stand, to make an impression; the noises you have renounced increase the anarchy
- s enemy. Innocence is delight in natural charm...there are only two fundamental attitudes: the naive and the heroic...innocence is lonely

Ernest Becker

- We should not be surprised that Rank was brought to exactly the same conclusion as Kierkegaard: that the only way out of human conflict is
- We know that he was a genius, and we can now see the real problem that genius has: how to develop a creative work with the full force of one's
- to do what Buddha did, to renounce everything. This is why it is so difficult to face reality and it
- • "And so he lives in a kind of incognito, content to toy in his periodic solitudes with the idea of who he might really be; content to
- s fitting that this task should fall to the strongest personality type, the one with the largest ego. The great scientific world-shaker Newton

Hinduism

- 23. Ask for sons and grandsons who will live A hundred years. Ask for herds of cattle, Elephants and horses, gold and vast land, And ask to

Jesus

- Sell that ye have, and give alms; provide yourselves bags which wax not old, a treasure in the heavens that faileth not, where no thief appâ€!

Kierkegaard

- All that can truly disarm the sophism of repentance is faith, courage to believe that the state itself is a new sin, courage without anxietâ€!
- or that he is to be respected as a person, to all appearance he is to be regarded as a person. In Christendom he is a Christian (quite in tâ€!
- is part of faith, and Kierkegaard said he could never quite make the â€œleapâ€ himself, I am not sure this sort of â€œfaithâ€ can be actualized, â€!
- re describing things perfectly) â€œOh, you sufferer, wherever you may be, wherever you hide from the sight of men in order to spare them fromâ€!

Lev Shestov

- In the words of Zarathustra quoted above, a stage of development is formulated which has become for modern man unavoidable. It is no longerâ€!
- As the reader can see, Nietzsche, contrary to the generally accepted opinion, did not listen to the immediate feelings of vindictiveness, bâ€!
- For it was one of two things: either Nietzsche was right, or his tragedy was indeed so profound, so unprecedentedly horrible that all peoplâ€!
- We now come to Kierkegaard's basic question: on whose side is the truth; on the side of "everybody" and "everybody's cowardice," or on the â€!
- Is not such a celebration of the "ethical," in Kierkegaard's work as well as Nietzsche's, simply an expression of profound, irreconcilable,â€!
- Two things have, I hope, become fairly clear to us by now. On the one hand, Kierkegaard resolves to suspend the "ethical," which is the expâ€!

Martin Heidegger

- (Me: This seems to be in the context of finitude, man's 'normal' situation of ignoring/repressing his finitude, but the 'moment of vision' â€!

Martin Luther

-) Works are not condemned, but devalued because they are Earthly. The only thing that matters is not of this earth, is not of this Kingdom, â€!

Meister Eckhart

- The man who abides in God's love must be dead to himself and all created things, and regard himself as a mere unit among a thousand millionâ€!

- s love must be dead to himself and all created things, and regard himself as a mere unit among a thousand million. Such a man must renounceâ€

Miguel de Molinos

- It is not enough for gaining this Treasure, to forsake the World, nor to renounce thine own Desires, and all things created; if thou wean nâ€
- O how many self confident men by their own judgment and opinion, undertake this Ministry; and instead of pleasing God, emptying and abstracâ€
- Their continual Exercise is, to enter into themselves, in God, with quiet and silence; because there is his Center, Habitation and Delight.â€
- Many there be, who, however they have been dedicated to Prayer, yet have no relish of God; because in the end of their Prayers, they are neâ€
- To the simple and the mortified, the recreation of the senses is a sort of death: they never go to it, unless compelled by necessity and edâ€
- s sake, does every thing; because, one pure Act of internal Resignation, is more worth than a hundred thousand Exercises for ones own Will.â€

Pascal

- We do not content ourselves with the life we have in ourselves and in our own being; we desire to live an imaginary life in the mind of othâ€
- And thus, when one is forced to play, he must renounce reason to preserve his life, rather than risk it for infinite gain, as likely to hapâ€
- t count the old man sleeping in the front) â€œOne thought alone occupies us; we cannot think of two things at the same time. This is lucky foâ€
- is something that goes almost utterly unexpressed by the new atheists and our current culture) â€œI find it necessary to point out the sinfulâ€

Peter Zappfe

- Is it possible for â€˜primitive naturesâ€™™ to renounce these cramps and cavorts and live in harmony with themselves in the serene bliss of laboâ€

St. John of the Cross

- Charity, too, in the same way empties the will of all things, for it compels us to love God above all, which we cannot do without withdrawiâ€

Taoism

- If we could renounce our sageness and discard our wisdom, it would be better for the people a hundredfold. If we could renounce our benevolâ€

- When we renounce learning we have no troubles. The (ready) 'yes,' and (flattering) 'yea;'â€” Small is the difference they display. But mark tâ€”
- With these three qualities, it cannot be made the subject of description; and hence we blend them together and obtain The One. Its upper paâ€”

Thomas Kempis

- How came it to pass that many of the Saints were so perfect, so contemplative of Divine things? Because they steadfastly sought to mortify â€”
- O how many and grievous tribulations did the Apostles, Martyrs, Confessors, Virgins, endure; and all others who would walk in the footstepsâ€”
- For it is not given unto all to renounce this world and its affairs, and to take up a religious life.
- "Oh how great a confidence shall there be to the dying man whom no affection to anything detaineth in the world? But to have a heart so sepâ€”
- Let, therefore, nothing which thou doest seem to thee great; let nothing be grand, nothing of value or beauty, nothing worthy of honour, noâ€”
-) â€œVain is the life of that man who putteth his trust in men or in any created Thing.â€© (there is no reason for disappointment from other peâ€”

Thomas Merton

- In order to meditate, I have to withdraw my mind from all that prevents me from attending to God present in my heart. This is impossible unâ€”

Tolstoy

- To live after God's Word, he must renounce all the pleasures of life, labour, be humble, endure, and be charitable to all men.
- These chapters I read very often, each time with the same emotional ardor, as I came to the verses which exhort the hearer to turn the otheâ€”
- In the Sermon on the Mount, as well as in many other places, Jesus represents his disciples, those who observe the rule of non-resistance tâ€”
- I now understood the words of Jesus: "Ye have heard that it hath been said, An eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth: but I say unto you,â€”
- Perhaps it is right to think that man, after this terrestrial life passed in the satisfaction of personal desires, will enter upon the possâ€”
- Our masters tell us that there are only two ways,â€”to believe in and obey the powers that be, to participate in the organized evil about us,â€”

Modesty/Humility

A. W. Tozer

- In the world of men we find nothing approaching the virtues of which Jesus spoke in the opening words of the famous Sermon on the Mount. Inâ€¹
- The labor of self-love is a heavy one indeed. Think for yourself whether much of your sorrow has not arisen from someone speaking slightingâ€¹

Angela of Foligno

- In that time and by Godâ€™s will there died my mother, who was a great hindrance unto me in following the way of God; my husband died likewiseâ€¹

Augustine

- But having then read those books of the Platonists, and thence been taught to search for incorporeal truth, I saw Thy invisible things, undâ€¹
- For it was not salvation that he taught in rhetoric (why, then, should he shrink from naming your name before the sheep of the flock), and â€¹

Bertrand Russell

- A truly scientific philosophy will be more humble, more piecemeal, more arduous, offering less glitter of outward mirage to flatter fallaciâ€¹

Buddhism

- "I am a Shâ€¹man, depressed and sad at thought of age, disease, and death; I have left my home to seek some way of rescue, but everywhere I fâ€¹
- â€œThe prince now entering the city, there met him men and women, earnest for their several ends; the old besought him for their children, thâ€¹
- s death; and yet men not awakened to the truth!â€¹ â€œ"I am a Shâ€¹man, depressed and sad at thought of age, disease, and death; I have left my hâ€¹

Ernest Becker

- We disguise our struggle by piling up figures in a bank book to reflect privately our sense of heroic worth. Or by having only a little betâ€¹
- It begins to look as though modern man cannot find his heroism in everyday life any more, as men did in traditional societies just by doingâ€¹
- t start wars, protest or make a big deal of anything, non-movement, etc. Pascal- if only men could learn to sit in their rooms) â€œWe have seâ€¹

Evelyn Underhill

- Believe me, children,
- Here East and West are in agreement: "Their science," says Al Ghazzali of the Sufis, who practised, like the early Franciscans, a complete â€¹

- is All. All takes place within Him. He alone matters, He alone is. Our spiritual life is His affair; because, whatever we may think to the effect!
- Prayer means turning to Reality, taking our part, however humble, tentative and half-understood, in the continual conversation, the communion!
- "In such cases as Kant and Beethoven," says Von Hartmann justly, "a classifier of humanity according to its psycho-physical phenomena alone will!"
- In that time and by God's will there died my mother, who was a great hindrance unto me in following the way of God: soon after my husband's death!

Hinduism

- 5. If a man performs his sacred works when these flames are shining, and the oblations follow at the right time, then they lead him as sun-rays!

Jesus

- Truly, I say to you, unless you turn and become like children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven. Whoever humbles himself like this!
- Truly, I say to you, only with difficulty will a rich person enter the kingdom of heaven. Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle!

John Bunyan

- For, as I said before, it is evident, that they who live after the flesh in the lusts thereof, do not really and seriously think on death, they!

Kierkegaard

- But in spite of the fact that a man has become fantastic in this fashion, he may nevertheless (although most commonly it becomes manifest) exist!
- ...man is invited to live on the most intimate terms with God! Furthermore, for this man's sake God came to the world, let himself be born, exist!
- Alas, men often enough confuse impatience with humble, obedient enthusiasm; impatience even lends itself to this confusion. When a man is anxious!
- Undeniably he is making a virtue out of a necessity, that is just the secret, that is certainly a most accurate designation for what he does!
- , it is Sin as Nihilism and Faith as living in the experience of Nihilism- almost Tillich verbatim. Non-movement, not concerned with action!
-) "He does not will the Good for the sake of the reward. He wills that the Good shall triumph through him, that he shall be the instrument, exist!"

Lev Shestov

- Is there any hint in all this of that which we call greatness? Is ethics at all interested in the fact that Job recovered his cattle, his gâ€¹
- He notes in his journal: "Only horror that has turned to despair can develop a man's higher powers." Journal, II, 204 â€œQuite a few men haveâ€¹
- Is not such a celebration of the "ethical," in Kierkegaard's work as well as Nietzsche's, simply an expression of profound, irreconcilable,â€¹
- But the fear of Nothingness has remained, and Kierkegaard cannot and does not want to forget about it. However, in order to retain at leastâ€¹
- The ethical and its "gifts" are not supreme. In the face of the horrors that befell Job, helpless love and powerless charity must themselvesâ€¹
- He lingers with particular attention, not to say fondness, over the famous passage from the Gospel of St. Luke: if you do not hate your fatâ€¹

Martin Luther

- First, God has promised certainly His grace to the humbled: that is, to the self-deploring and despairing. But a man cannot be thoroughly hâ€¹

Miguel de Molinos

- That thou mayest not lose internal peace, it is necessary thou believe, that it is the goodness of divine mercy, when thus it humbles, afflâ€¹
- It concerns thee only then, to prepare thine heart, like clean paper, wherein the divine wisdom may imprint characters to his own liking. Oâ€¹
- Our own nature is so base, proud and ambitious, and so full of its own appetites, its own judgements and opinions, that if temptations restâ€¹
- That thou mayest not lose internal peace, it is necessary thou believe, that it is the goodness of divine mercy, when thus it humbles, afflâ€¹
- It is of so great Efficacy, that it rejects worldly Honour, Self-conceit, Spiritual Ambition, the desire of Fame, a wish to be Great, a preâ€¹
- how, O Lord, can a miserable creature receive an infinite Majesty? humble thy self, O my soul, to the very depth of nothing, confess thy unâ€¹

Miguel de Unamuno

- All this talk of a man surviving in his children, or in his works, or in the universal consciousness, is but vague verbiage which satisfiesâ€¹

Montaigne

- They go, they come, they gallop and dance, and not a word of death. All this is very fine; but withal, when it comes either to themselves, â€¹

Nietzsche

- Christianity as Antiquity. "When on a Sunday morning we hear the old bells ringing, we ask ourselves: Is it possible? All this for a Jew crucified!"
- What the "glad tidings" tell us is simply that there are no more contradictions; the kingdom of heaven belongs to children; the faith that "all is possible"
- It has gradually become clear to me what every great philosophy up till now has consisted of "namely, the confession of its originator, and "all is possible"
- Whoever has seen deeply into the world has doubtless divined what wisdom there is in the fact that men are superficial. It is their preservation!
- Existence has no goal or end... "all is possible" (this is the experience that brings one to the Ground, Nothingness. Is this similar to Otto's "creatureliness"?
- "The distance, and as it were the space around man, grows with the strength of his intellectual vision and insight: his world becomes profound!"

Pascal

- The property of justice is to humble pride, however holy may be our work...and the property of mercy is to combat sloth by exhorting to good!
- It is better not to fast, and thereby humbled, than to fast and be self-satisfied therewith.

Peter Zappfe

- In everyday interaction, isolation is manifested in a general code of mutual silence: primarily toward children, so these are not at once satisfied!

Plato /Socrates

- ...when he sees the beautiful one he is ready to die of fear. And from that time forward the soul of the lover follows the beloved in modes!
- And in this instance, you who are the father of letters, from a paternal love of your own children have been led to attribute to them a quality!
- humility is always present) "And in this instance, you who are the father of letters, from a paternal love of your own children have been led!"

St. John of the Cross

- It is evident that the faith is a dark night to the soul, and it is thus that it gives it light; the more it darkens the soul the more does it!
- There are other of these spiritual persons, again, who fall into another kind of spiritual wrath: this happens when they become irritated at!
- ...immersed in the realization of those evils wherein it sees its own miseries so clearly, that it thinks that, as its director observes not!
- "all is possible" "I see that Jesus Christ is but little known by those who consider themselves His friends. These, loving themselves very much, seek in!"

Swami Vivekananda

- 'Lord give me more wealth, more children, more territory' This is not the language of love.
- Where do you ever see love in fear? It is always a sham. With love never comes the idea of fear. Think of a young mother in the street: if
- This is not the language of love. Where do you ever see love in fear? It is always a sham. With love never comes the idea of fear. Think

Taoism

- (The Tao) which originated all under the sky is to be considered as the mother of them all. When the mother is found, we know what her child
- is lot; no fault greater than the wish to be getting. Therefore the sufficiency of contentment is an enduring and unchanging sufficiency.

Theresa of Avila

- All that such souls ever attain to and perform, all these things only make them more humble, and therefore more strong; more able to despise
- I do not mean, by "leaving" everything, entering the religious life, for there may be obstacles to this, and the soul that is perfect can

Thomas Kempis

- It is good that we sometimes endure contradictions, and are hardly and unfairly judged, when we do and mean what is good. For these things
- ...all our peace in this sad life lieth in humble suffering rather than in not feeling adversities.
- ...a diligent seeker after virtue, falleth not back upon those comforts, nor seeketh such sweetness as may be tasted and handled, but desireth
- It is not in the nature of man to bear the cross, to love the cross, to keep under the body and to bring it into subjection, to fly from
- For when thou fleest away from being abased and confounded for thy faults, it is plain that thou art neither truly humble nor truly dead to
-) Vain is the life of that man who putteth his trust in men or in any created Thing. (there is no reason for disappointment from other people)

Thomas Ligotti

- Since Buddhism's only objective is attaining enlightenment, that high road to nirvana (see below), it is at one with other religions in

Tolstoy

- The new circumstances of a happy family life by which I was now surrounded completely led my mind away from the search after the meaning of life
- no longer taste sweet to me. "My family," thought I; "but a family, a wife and children, are also human beings, and subject to the same conditions"
- To live after God's Word, he must renounce all the pleasures of life, labour, be humble, endure, and be charitable to all men.
- Do you say that the doctrine of Jesus, "Resist not evil," is vain? What, then, are we to think of the lives of those who are not filled with it?
- I sought to imagine the results if, instead of extolling our social organization as it now is, with its theatres, its romances, its sumptuousness
- To live for self alone, for the animal life, is not reasonable. And so men, from their earliest existence, have sought for some reason for life

William James

- "I must first pass a sentence of death," he says, "upon everything that can properly be called a thing of this life, even to reckon myself,"
- upon everything that can properly be called a thing of this life, even to reckon myself, my wife, my children, my health, my enjoyments, and

William Lane Craig-

- "I pretend the universe has meaning." And this is just fooling ourselves. The point is this: if God does not exist, then life is objectively meaningless

Quest for the Boundless/Transcendent

A. W. Tozer

- A spiritual kingdom lies all about us, enclosing us, embracing us, altogether within reach of our inner selves, waiting for us to recognize it

Albert Camus

- Kierkegaard may shout in warning: "If man had no eternal consciousness, if, at the bottom of everything, there were merely a wild, seething"

Aldous Huxley

- to see these trousers as infinitely important and human beings as still more infinitely important.
- ...I found myself all at once on the brink of panic. This, I suddenly felt, was going too far. Too far, even though the going was into it
- But for poor Renee, the schizophrenic, the illumination is infernal - an intense electric glare without a shadow, ubiquitous and implacable

- And then there is the horror of infinity. For the healthy visionary, the perception The literature of religious experience abounds in reference!
- Sanity is a matter of degree, and there are plenty of visionaries who see the world as Renee saw it, but contrive, none the less, to live with it!
- Of those who die an infinitesimal minority are capable of immediate union with the divine Ground, a few are capable of supporting the vision!

Angela of Foligno

- "Blessed (saith He), verily blessed is, and shall be, he who loveth poverty in all the aforesaid things and who desireth to be truly poor in it!"

Augustine

- ...for that the body which is corrupted presseth down the soul, and the earthly tabernacle weigheth down the mind that museth upon many things!
- But having then read those books of the Platonists, and thence been taught to search for incorporeal truth, I saw Thy invisible things, understand!
- of such is the Kingdom of Heaven
- ...a certain cottage where lived some of your servants, some of the 'poor in spirit' (of such is the kingdom of heaven).
- Thus I tore my hair out, struck my forehead, or, entwining my fingers, clasped my knee, these I did because I willed it...Yet I did not do it!
- For he saw that the causes of things were sought for by them,--which causes he believed to be ultimately reducible to nothing else than the!

Bertrand Russell

- To abandon the struggle for private happiness, to expel all eagerness of temporary desire, to burn with passion for eternal things--this is it!

Buddhism

- "Absence, extinction, and unoccupancy--these are not the Buddhist conception of emptiness. Buddhists' Emptiness is not on the plane of relation!"

Edgar Saltus

- Leopardi at that time was in his twenty-seventh year, and the task to which he then devoted himself was, he said, to be the sad ending of it!
- In ancient philosophy, ethics was a treatise of happiness; in modern works, it is generally a doctrine of eternal salvation; to Schopenhauer!
- there is also a haphazard pessimism which comes of an unevenness of disposition, and which asserts itself on a rainy day, or when stocks are!

- s philosophers)d âœThey are merely the resultants of the obvious and the true; they leap into being in every intelligent mind.â€® (me- recolleâ€¹
-) âœIn ancient philosophy, ethics was a treatise of happiness; in modern works, it is generally a doctrine of eternal salvation; to Schopenhâ€¹

Emile Cioran

- why can't we stay closed up inside ourselves? why do we chase after expression and form, trying to deliver ourselves of our precious contenâ€¹
- the vulgar interpretation of universality calls it a phenomenon of quantitative expansion rather than a qualitatively rich containment. sucâ€¹
- the experience of suffering is a similar case. you never suspected what lay hidden in yourself and in the world, you were living contentedlâ€¹
- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreaâ€¹
- true solitude is the feeling of being absolutely isolated between the earth and the sky. nothing should detract attention from these phenomâ€¹
- how good it would be if one could die by throwing oneself into an infinite void!

Ernest Becker

- ...wondered why most people did not become insane in the face of the existential contradiction between a symbolic self, that seems to give â€¹
- One goes through it all to arrive at faith, the faith that one s very creatureliness has some meaning to a Creator; that despite oneâ€™s trueâ€¹
- man who is educated by possibility is educated in accordance with his infinity.
- He is absolutely alone and trembling on the brink of oblivionâ€¹" which is at the same time the brink of infinity.
- Gods can take in the whole of creation because they alone can make sense of it, know what it is all about and for. But as soon as a man lifâ€¹
- Here Rank and Kierkegaard meet in one of those astonishing historical mergers of thought: that sin and neurosis are two ways of talking aboâ€¹

Evelyn Underhill

- As a corollary to these four rules, it is perhaps well to reiterate the statement already made, that True Mysticism is never self-seeking. â€¹
- All its activities are grouped about a centre of consciousness whose correspondences are with the material world. In the moment of its awakâ€¹
- She disguised herself in a hermit's dress- she had no one to help or advise her--and "went out of her chamber about Four in the Morning, taâ€¹
- "The soul is plunged in utter p. 221 ignorance, when she supposes that she can attain to the high estate of union with God before she castsâ€¹

- The real distinction between the Illuminative and the Unitive Life is that in Illumination the individuality of the subject--however profound--
- "The soul," he says, "with all its powers, has divided and scattered itself in outward things, each according to its functions: the power of

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- And indeed the Christian is, in a certain sense--in an ultimate sense--a "Nihilist"; for to him, in the end, the world is nothing, and God is
- We have killed him (God), you and I! We are all his murderers! But how have we done it? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us the
- is a "Nihilism" that proceeds from abundance. The true Nihilist places his faith in things that pass away and end in nothing; all "optimism"

GK Chesterton

- St. John the Evangelist saw many strange monsters in his vision, he saw no creature so wild as one of his own commentators. The general fact is

Herman T. Å, nnessen

- One of the simplest forms of suffocation (offering happiness and peace of mind through the most comfortable evasions and illusions) consists in
- Thrown into an eternally changing universe, human beings cannot be tied by a set of rigid rules for language, thought, or action.

Hinduism

- 23. Ask for sons and grandsons who will live A hundred years. Ask for herds of cattle, Elephants and horses, gold and vast land, And ask to
- 6. 'That which cannot be seen, nor seized, which has no family and no caste, no eyes nor ears, no hands nor feet, the eternal, the omnipresent'
- 5. If a man performs his sacred works when these flames are shining, and the oblations follow at the right time, then they lead him as sun--
- s edge, the sages say, Is the path, difficult to traverse. The supreme Self is beyond name and form, Beyond the senses, inexhaustible, With

Huston Smith

- Drug experiences that assume a religious cast tend to have fearful and/or beatific features.

Jesus

- Therefore do not be anxious, saying, 'What shall we eat?' or 'What shall we drink?' or 'What shall we wear?' For the Gentiles seek after all these!
- Truly, I say to you, unless you turn and become like children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven. Whoever humbles himself like this will be great in the kingdom of heaven.
- Truly, I say to you, only with difficulty will a rich person enter the kingdom of heaven. Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich person to enter the kingdom of God.
- Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink; nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on. Is not the life more than food, and the body more than raiment? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they toil not, neither do they spin: And yet I say unto you, That even so will the Father clothe the lilies of the field with apparel: how much more will he clothe you, O ye of little faith!

John Shelby Spong

- Our task is to separate the eternal experience from the time-bound and time-warped explanations.

Kierkegaard

- So then it is an infinite advantage to be able to despair; and yet it is not only the greatest misfortune and misery to be in despair; no, "but"
- ...man's life is wasted who lived on, so deceived by the joys of life or by its sorrows that he never became eternally and decisively conscious!
- So then it is an infinite advantage to be able to despair...
- The despair which is the passageway to faith is also by the aid of the eternal: by the aid of the eternal the self has courage to lose itself!
- The possibility of this sickness is man's advantage over the beast; to be sharply observant of this sickness constitutes the Christian's advantage!
- ...so much is said about wasted lives "but" only that man's life is wasted who lived on, so deceived by the joys of life or by its sorrows "but"

Lev Shestov

- Of God, such a God as he who has understood all the horror of his own helplessness needs, a God who, as Heine put it, "is able to help" - oâ€¹!
- For it was one of two things: either Nietzsche was right, or his tragedy was indeed so profound, so unprecedentedly horrible that all peoplê€¹!
- Nietzsche was and always remained sympathetic only to the language of skepticism - and not, of course, the skepticism of the drawing room oâ€¹!
- Earthly misfortunes, however terrible or grand they may be, do not give man a deciding voice at the council of the great and eternal forcesâ€¹!
- Only in the Bible is there an indication that all is not well with reason and the eternal truths conveyed by reason. God warned man againstâ€¹!
- The choice is made for him by Nothingness, whichâ€¹"Kierkegaard, again, has told us of thisâ€¹" turns out to be a Proteus. In the beginning it asâ€¹!

Martin Heidegger

- (Me: This seems to be in the context of finitude, man's 'normal' situation of ignoring/repressing his finitude, but the 'moment of vision' â€
- , indefinable, finite/infinite distinction, it is a call of oneself by oneself (Vivekananda and eastern/mystical conceptions of
- the finite/infinite distinction? Seems to be. This clash, battle, unbridgable gap of the finite/infinite allows for a Heidegger to live mosâ€

Martin Luther

- Therefore, it is not irreligious, curious, or superfluous, but essentially wholesome and necessary, for a Christian to know, whether or notâ€
- Thus, when God makes alive, He does it by killing; when He justifies, He does it by bringing in guilty: when He exalts to Heaven, He does iâ€
- But how much better is it to lose the whole world, than to lose God the Creator of the world, who can create innumerable worlds again, and â€

Meister Eckhart

- s love must be dead to himself and all created things, and regard himself as a mere unit among a thousand million. Such a man must renounceâ€

Miguel de Molinos

- Many Souls when they suffer these painful torments, are troubled, afflicted, and disquieted, it seeming to them, that they begin already inâ€
- The Senses are not capable of divine Blessings; hence if thou would be Happy and Wise; be Silent and Believe; Suffer and have Patience; be â€
- Our own nature is so base, proud and ambitious, and so full of its own appetites, its own judgements and opinions, that if temptations restâ€
- No sooner wilt thou have given thy self up to thy Lord in this inward Way, but all Hell will conspire against thee, seeing one single Soul â€
- In the time of the recollection, Peace and Resignation of thy Soul, God will more esteem the various impertinent, troublesome and ugly thouâ€
- How many have begun this happy practice of Prayer, and Internal Recollection, and have left it off, pretending that they feel no pleasure, â€

Miguel de Unamuno

- All knowledge has an ultimate object. Knowledge for the sake of knowledge is, say what you will, nothing but a dismal begging of the questiâ€
- Nothing is real that is not eternal.

- The methodical doubt of Descartes is a comic doubt, a doubt purely theoretical and provisionalâ€”that is to say, the doubt of a man who acts â€”
- We have created God in order to save the Universe from nothingness, for all that is not consciousness and eternal consciousness, conscious â€”
- "If of two men," says Kierkegaard, " one prays to the true God without sincerity of heart, and the other prays to an idol with all the passâ€”
- The consciousness that everything passes away, that we ourselves pass away, and that everything that is ours and everything that environs uâ€”

Nietzsche

- We have killed him (God), you and I! We are all his murderers! But how have we done it? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us tâ€”
- And as far as my long illness is concerned, am I not infinitely more indebted to it than to my health? I owe to it a higher health, one sucâ€”
- The Everyday Christian.â€”If Christianity, with its allegations of an avenging God, universal sinfulness, choice of grace, and the danger of â€”
- Religious wars only result, when human reason generally has been refined by the subtle disputes of sects ; so that even the populace becomeâ€”
- an imaginary teleology (the "kingdom of God," "the last judgment," "eternal life").--This purely fictitious world, greatly to its disadvantâ€”
- The Christian concept of a god--the god as the patron of the sick, the god as a spinner of cobwebs, the god as a spirit--is one of the mostâ€”

Pascal

- We do not require great education of the mind to understand that here is no real and lasting satisfaction; that our pleasures are only vaniâ€”
- Returning to himself, let man consider what he is in comparison with all existence; let him regard himself as lost in this remote corner ofâ€”
- Let him see therein an infinity of universes, each of which has its firmament, its planets, its earth, in the same proportion as in the visâ€”
- Through failure to contemplate these Infinities, men have rashly rushed into the examination of nature, as though they bore some proportion â€”
- Let us then take our compass; we are something, and we are not everything. The nature of our existence hides from us the knowledge of firstâ€”
- This is our true state; this is what makes us incapable of certain knowledge and of absolute ignorance. We sail within a vast sphere, ever â€”

Paul Tillich

- Man is driven towards faith by his awareness of the infinite.
- ...is the passion for the infinite.

- The human heart seeks the infinite because that is where the finite wants to rest. In the infinite it sees its own fulfillment.
- ...the infinite distance of the finite from the infinite and, consequently, the negative judgment over any finite attempts to reach the infinite!
- ...there is no way of reaching the infinite.
- An act of faith is an act of a finite being who is grasped by and turned to the infinite.

Plato /Socrates

- Moreover, I said, you must not wonder that those who attain to this beatific vision are unwilling to descend to human affairs; for their souls!
- What infinite delight would there be in conversing with them and asking them questions! In another world they do not put a man to death for!

Schopenhauer

- This is the realm of finality; and its opposite would be an infinite existence, exposed to no attack from without, and needing nothing to!

St. John of the Cross

- The whole creation (all wisdom, sweetness, goodness, liberty, riches, etc.), compared with the infinite Being of God, is nothing; and so the!
- The earth "void and nothing," signifies that the earth and all it contains are nothing, and the heavens without light, that all the lights!
- The whole creation, compared with the infinite Being of God, is nothing; and so the soul whose affections are set on created things is noth!
- All the grace and comeliness of creation, compared with the Grace of God, is supreme disgrace and supreme disfavour, and that soul, therefo!
- All the goodness of the whole world together, in comparison with the infinite Goodness of God, is wickedness rather than goodness, for "No!"
- All the riches and glory of the whole creation compared with the true riches, which is God, is supreme poverty and meanness, and he who set!

Swami Vivekananda

- The reality of everything is the same infinite. This is not idealism; it is not that the world does not exist. It has a relative existence,!
- "Seek ye first the kingdom of God, and everything shall be added unto you." This is the one great duty, this is renunciation. Live for an i!
- It is vain to preach against the use of symbols, and why should we preach against them? There is no reason why man should not use symbols. !
- A disciple went to his master and said to him, "Sir, I want religion." The master looked at the young man, and did not speak, but only smil!

- Seek ye first the kingdom of God, and everything shall be added unto you.
- , as Vivekananda defines him, that does not realize the truths of religion) "Who wants God? That is the question. Do you think that all thi

Therese of Lisieux

- I have obtained many spiritual lights through the works of St. John of the Cross. When I was seventeen and eighteen they were my only food;
- ...I felt that one day I should be set free from this land of darkness. I believed it, not only because I had been told so by others, but
- Marie, though you are nothing, do not forget that Jesus is All. You have only to lose your own nothingness in that Infinite All, and thence
- "No doubt, dear Mother, you will think I exaggerate somewhat the night of my soul. If you judge by the poems I have composed this year, it
- Ah! What attracted me was Jesus hidden in the depths of her soul--Jesus who maketh sweet even that which is most bitter." (Vivekananda- see
- "Believe me, the writing of pious books, the composing of the sublimest poetry, all that does not equal the smallest act of self-denial..."

Thomas Kempis

- O how many and grievous tribulations did the Apostles, Martyrs, Confessors, Virgins, endure; and all others who would walk in the footsteps
- The kingdom of God is within you,(1) saith the Lord. Turn thee with all thine heart to the Lord and forsake this miserable world, and thou
- Then thou shalt make great progress if thou keep thyself free from all temporal care. Thou shalt lamentably fall away if thou set a value
- "Let, therefore, nothing which thou doest seem to thee great; let nothing be grand, nothing of value or beauty, nothing worthy of honour,
- Let temporal things be in the use, eternal things in the desire. Thou canst not be satisfied with any temporal good, for thou wast not crea
- Let, therefore, nothing which thou doest seem to thee great; let nothing be grand, nothing of value or beauty, nothing worthy of honour, no

Thomas Ligotti

- Even as we survive and reproduce, we know ourselves to be dying in a dark corner of infinity.
- No self now, consciously speaking. No feeling your old self or new self, false imaginings if you think about it, self-conscious nothings ev

Thomas Merton

- ...God is infinitely above us, although He is within us and is the principle of our being.

- We have to enter into our meditation with a realization of our spiritual poverty, our complete lack of the things we seek, and of our abjection!
- It is usually better to remain quiet, to be still. But there is no reason why one should not also meditate walking up and down in a garden!

Tolstoy

- If a man lives, he believes in something. If he did not believe that there was something to live for, he would not live. If he does not see!
- Free your minds from those overgrown, mountainous imbecilities which hinder your recognition of it, and at once the truth will emerge from it!
- The principal difference between our conception of human life and that possessed by the Jews is, that while we believe that our mortal life!
- Perhaps it is right to think that man, after this terrestrial life passed in the satisfaction of personal desires, will enter upon the possible!
- We believe that the happiness of our life is in power, and domination, and abundance of worldly goods. We are so habituated to this idea that!
- To be poor means not to live in cities, but in the country, not to be shut up in close rooms, but to labor out of doors, in the woods and fields!

William James

- The persons to whom I refer have still retained for the most part their nominal connection with Christianity, in spite of their discarding it!

William Lane Craig-

- Thus they yelled and laughed. Then, writes Nietzsche, the madman turned in their midst and pierced them with his eyes 'Whither is God?' he asked!
- I shall tell you. We have killed him!—you and I. All of us are his murderers. But how have we done this? How were we able to drink up the sea?

Seclusion/Solitude

Aldous Huxley

- And then there is the horror of infinity. For the healthy visionary, the perception The literature of religious experience abounds in references!

Augustine

- ...undertake a peaceful life, away from the crowds.
- As they rambled, these first two came upon a certain cottage where lived some of thy servants, some of the poorest in spirit

- ...a certain cottage where lived some of your servants, some of the 'poor in spirit' (of such is the kingdom of heaven).
- ...so, with hearts lingering on the earth, went away to the palace. But the other two, fixing their heart on heaven, remained in the cottage!
- For it was not salvation that he taught in rhetoric (why, then, should he shrink from naming your name before the sheep of the flock), and
- his reading of the Bible during his experience- "Not in rioting and drunkenness, not in chambering and wantonness, not in strife and envying,"

Buddhism

- what rest or quiet can there be! Alas! that worldly men, blinded by ignorance and oppressed with dark delusion, though the robber sickness
- "I am a Shāçman, depressed and sad at thought of age, disease, and death; I have left my home to seek some way of rescue, but everywhere I find
- Would that you would listen with attentive mind; we know that you delight to act religiously; it is certain, then, without a doubt, this is
- On this, turning his chariot back again, he grieved to think upon the pain of sickness. As a man beaten and wounded sore, with body weakened
- his death; and yet men not awakened to the truth! "I am a Shāçman, depressed and sad at thought of age, disease, and death; I have left my home

Edgar Saltus

- He was not much over twenty before excessive study had well-nigh ruined such health as he once possessed. The slightest application was wearisome
- ...whatever their private beliefs may be, they still wish their neighbors to think that they at least have no cause to complain. It is this
- ...the moral atmosphere of the present century is charged with three distinct disturbances, the waning of religious belief, the insatiable
- He considered that, as a rule, a man is never in perfect harmony save with himself, for, he argued, however tenderly a friend or mistress
- The love of solitude, however, cannot be considered otherwise than as an acquired taste; it must come as the result of experience and reflection
- Chamfort says somewhere, very wittily, "It is sometimes said of a man that he lives alone and does not care for society; this is very much

Emile Cioran

- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreams
- i feel i must burst because of all that life offers me and because of the prospect of death. i feel that i am dying of solitude, of love, of

- true solitude is the feeling of being absolutely isolated between the earth and the sky. nothing should detract attention from these phenomena!
- i see a form of madness, not of knowledge, in the ecstasy of life's ultimate origins. You cannot experience it except in solitude, when you!
- isn't intense subjectivity the way to attain universality, exactly as one enters eternity through the instant? men value solitude so little!
- so you witnessed old age, pain, and death and told yourself that pleasure is an illusion and that the pleasure seekers do not understand that!

Ernest Becker

- I don't know who he is, why he was born, what he is doing on the planet, what he is supposed to do, what he can expect. His own existence is inconceivable!
- • "And so he lives in a kind of 'incognito,' content to toy" in his periodic solitudes "with the idea of who he might really be; content to be!"

Evelyn Underhill

- Thus Molinos gives in the "Spiritual Guide" many unexceptional maxims upon Interior Silence: "By not speaking nor desiring, and not thinking!"
- she arrives at the true and perfect mystical silence wherein God speaks with the soul, communicates Himself to it, and in the abyss of its!
- , it is an attempt at the impossible: an understanding of God, and I think that Molinos would agree with all of this) "Thus Molinos gives!"

Kierkegaard

- On the other hand, he often feels a need of solitude, which for him is a vital necessity -- sometimes like breathing, at other times like!

Lev Shestov

- This sympathy invariably deceives itself as to its power; woman would like to believe that love can do everything - it is her peculiar superstition!
- satisfied him completely. But Nietzsche, according to all the evidence, could not think thus, for this would have meant depriving God of his!
- I doubt, that the formula "the good = fraternal love = God" satisfied him completely. But Nietzsche, according to all the evidence, could not!

Martin Heidegger

- (Me: This seems to be in the context of finitude, man's 'normal' situation of ignoring/repressing his finitude, but the 'moment of vision' !)

- injunctions, solely because it summons Dasein to existence, to its ownmost potentiality-for-Being-its-Self. With the maxims which one mightâ€

Meister Eckhart

- Three things hinder us from hearing the everlasting Word. The first is fleshliness, the second is distraction, the third is the illusion ofâ€
- s love.â€ (Kierkegaard) â€œHe is the end of all creation. This end is concealed in the darkness of the everlasting Godhead, and is unknown, anâ€

Miguel de Molinos

- The spiritual Director, which lives disinterested, longs more for the internal Solitude than the Employment of Souls: and if any spiritual â€

Nietzsche

- I sentenced myself to absolute solitude, and to a severance from all those conditions in life to which I had grown accustomed ; my discipliâ€
- I would die in unclean surroundings,-I swim, bathe, and splash about, as it were, incessantly in water, in any kind of perfectly transparenâ€
- It is from this passage, and from no other, that you must set out to understand the goal to which Zarathustra aspires-the kind of man that â€

Paul Tillich

- Faith is not an act of any of his rational functions, as it is not an act of the unconscious, but it is an act in which both the rational â€
- Without some participation in the object of one's ultimate concern, it is not possible to be concerned about it. In this sense ebvery act oâ€
- (participation! Turning inward, contemplation, meditation, solitude)
- s ultimate concern, it is not possible to be concerned about it. In this sense ebvery act of faith presupposes participation in that towardâ€

Theresa of Avila

- You need not go to heaven to see God, or to regale yourself with God. Nor need you speak loud as if He were far away. Nor need you cry for â€
- What sufferings they bore, what solitude, cold, thirst and hunger, what burning sun and heat! And yet they had no one to complain to exceptâ€

Thomas Ligotti

- Because no two minds are contoured alike, no one system or collocation of systems will ever be sized to fit all. If truth is what you seek,â€

Reflection/Contemplation

A. W. Tozer

- Again, he recommends that in prayer we practice a further stripping down of everything, even of our theology.
- I do not want to leave the impression that the ordinary means of grace have no value. They most assuredly have. Private prayer should be private!

Aldous Huxley

- Let me add, before we leave this subject, that there is no form of contemplation, even the most quietistic, which is without its ethical value!
- The one-sided contemplative leaves undone many things that he ought to do; but to make up for it, he refrains from doing a host of things which he should do!
- Over against the quietist stands the active-contemplative, the saint, the man who, in Eckhart's phrase, is ready to come down from the seventh heaven!
- Mescaline opens up the way of Mary, but shuts the door on that of Martha. It gives access to contemplation—but to a contemplation that is inferior!
- Alas, this paradise of cleansed perception, of pure one-sided contemplation, was not to endure. The blissful intermissions became rarer, briefer!
- We should talk less and draw more. I personally should like to renounce speech altogether and, like organic Nature, communicate everything instinctively!

Augustine

- Thus the thoughts by which I meditated upon thee were like the efforts of one who would awake, but being overpowered with sleepiness is soothed!
- For he saw that the causes of things were sought for by them,—which causes he believed to be ultimately reducible to nothing else than thee!
- For it was not salvation that he taught in rhetoric (why, then, should he shrink from naming your name before the sheep of the flock), and he!

Bertrand Russell

- To abandon the struggle for private happiness, to expel all eagerness of temporary desire, to burn with passion for eternal things—this is the goal!

Buddhism

- what rest or quiet can there be! Alas! that worldly men, blinded by ignorance and oppressed with dark delusion, though the robber sickness of the heart!
- "I am a Shākyaman, depressed and sad at thought of age, disease, and death; I have left my home to seek some way of rescue, but everywhere I find the same suffering!"

- This, then, would be the consequence of compliance: that I, who, delighting in religion, am gradually getting wisdom, should now quit theseâ€¦!
- "For having spewed forth lust, passion, and ignorance, shall I return to feed upon it? as a man might go back to his vomit! such misery, hoâ€¦!"
- If you may not grant me these four prayers, then let me go I pray, and leave my home. O! place no difficulties in my path; your son is dwelâ€¦!
- s life; hearing of my father, the king, and his grief, my heart is affected with increased love; but yet, all is like the fancy of a dream,â€¦!

Ecclesiastes

- Better is a handful of quietness than two hands full of toil and a striving after wind.

Edgar Saltus

- There are those, too, who from dyspepsia, torpidity of the liver, or general crankiness of disposition, are inclined to take a gloomy view â€¦!
- To all this advanced pessimism has a ready answer: first, there can be no morality, for where there is no body and no property it is impossâ€¦!
- For pessimism, while showing that each joy is an illusion, leaves pleasure where it found it, and simply incloses it in a black border, froâ€¦!
- What its final solution will be is, of course, uncertain. Schopenhauer recommended absolute chastity as the means to the great goal, and Haâ€¦!
- is the explicit warning of the Founder of Christianity, and to this warning all creeds, save that of the early Hellenists, concur. It did nâ€¦!
- there is also a haphazard pessimism which comes of an unevenness of disposition, and which asserts itself on a rainy day, or when stocks arâ€¦!

Emile Cioran

- yet other philosophies and doctrines say almost nothing about death. the only valid attitude is absolute silence or a cry of despair. some â€¦!
- metaphysical existentialism is born out of ecstasy in front of the world's primordial origins; it is the ultimate intoxication, ecstatic blâ€¦!
- the feeling of utter confusion! not to be able to differentiate, clarify, understand, or appreciate! such a feeling would make any philosopâ€¦!
- the experience of eternity therefore depends on intensity of subjective feeling, and the way to eternity is to transcend the temporal...eveâ€¦!
- why should i live in history, or worry about the social and cultural problems of the age? i am weary of culture and history; i can no longeâ€¦!
- magic is useful for small and inessential things, but powerless when confronted with metaphysical reality, which requires, most of the timeâ€¦!

Evelyn Underhill

- It appears generally from these that the act of contemplation is for the mystic a psychic gateway; a method of going from one level of consciousness to another
- The value of contemplation is that it tends to produce this state, release this transcendental sense; and so turns the "lower servitude"
- cannot both perform their work at once: but if the soul shall see with the right eye into eternity, then the left eye must close itself and " "
- Transcendental matters are, for most of us, always beyond the margin; because most of us have given up our whole consciousness to the occupation of the material
- The phenomenon known as double or disintegrated personality may perhaps give us a hint as to the mechanical nature of the change which contemplation brings about
- To let oneself go, be quiet, receptive, appears to be the condition under which such contact with the Cosmic Life may be obtained.

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- not only in prayer and penance, but also in his political commitments and in all his social responsibilities.
- prayer and penance
- What is needed is not more busyness but a deeper penetration within. Not less fasting, but more; not more action, but prayer and penance. I believe that
- others, Vivekananda) "You speak of "Christian action," but the Christian who manifests the truth of the Gospel in social action, is not only in the world, but

Herman T. J. M. nessen

- ...cognitive...empathetic 'disintegrity'...to hold cognitively incompatible views or positions...to prevent knowledge from penetrating 'voluntarily'...
- to have a dime for the jukebox; the room is painfully satiated with embarrassing silence. Instantly and unexpectedly he is struck by an executioner's sword

Kierkegaard

- ...one might say perhaps that there lives not one single man who after all is not to some extent in despair, in whose inmost parts there dwells the devil
- No, to be in error or delusion is (quite un-Socratically) the thing they fear the least. One may behold amazing examples which illustrate this
- But in spite of the fact that a man has become fantastic in this fashion, he may nevertheless (although most commonly it becomes manifest) "be himself"
- If this introversion is absolutely maintained, omnibus numeris absoluta perfect in every respect, then suicide will be the danger nearest to him

- And, oh, when the hour-glass has run out, the hourglass of time, when the noise of worldliness is silenced, and the restless or the ineffecâ€
- A man of prayer does not pore over learned books for he is the wise man â€œwhose eyes are opened

Lev Shestov

- I repeat, it is an error to think that Nietzsche's experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it occurs perhaps much more â€
- And yet Job rejected all the consolations philosophiae, all the "deceitful consolations" of human wisdomâ€ and the God of the Bible not onlyâ€
- It may be that in a certain sense, i.e., "practically speaking," men are right: but they have not the strength to reduce madness and death â€
- "Picture two believers," he says, addressing the reader; "one of them has passed his life on earth happily, without knowing poverty or sickâ€
- Thus Spoke Zarathustraâ€ â€œI repeat, it is an error to think that Nietzsche's experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it â€
- men are right: but they have not the strength to reduce madness and death to silence. Madness and death can be driven away temporarily, butâ€

Martin Heidegger

- For the daring, dread is not an opponent of joy or even of the comfortable pleasures of quiet busyness. It shares a secret bond with the châ€
- (Me: This seems to be in the context of finitude, man's 'normal' situation of ignoring/repressing his finitude, but the 'moment of vision' â€
- injunctions, solely because it summons Dasein to existence, to its ownmost potentiality-for-Being-its-Self. With the maxims which one mightâ€
- s only napping. Its breath permanently trembles in existence, only slightly in the apprehensive, and inaudibly in the "Uh hÃ°h!" and "HÃ°h uhâ€

Martin Luther

-) Works are not condemned, but devalued because they are Earthly. The only thing that matters is not of this earth, is not of this Kingdom, â€

Meister Eckhart

- Therefore deadly sin is a breach of nature, a death of the soul, a disquiet of the heart, a weakening of power, a blindness of the sense, aâ€
- Deadly sin is also a disquiet of the heart, for everything rests nowhere except in its own proper place; and the proper resting-place of thâ€
- God has remained from everlasting in immovable sanctity, and still remains so. When He created heaven and earth and all creatures, His sancâ€

- Ways of living are many; one lives thus, and another thus; but whosoever will reach the highest life, let him in a few words hear the conclâ€¹
- s good works and prayers, as though they had accomplished none, and He is by those means no more favourably inclined towards men than if thâ€¹

Miguel de Molinos

- Many Souls when they suffer these painful torments, are troubled, afflicted, and disquieted, it seeming to them, that they begin already inâ€¹
- Think not that when thou art dry and darksom in the presence of God, with faith and silence, that thou do'st nothing, that thou lovest timeâ€¹
- It concerns thee only then, to prepare thine heart, like clean paper, wherein the divine wisdom may imprint characters to his own liking. Oâ€¹
- Internal Recollection is Faith, and Silence in the Presence of God.
- In the time of the recollection, Peace and Resignation of thy Soul, God will more esteem the various impertinent, troublesome and ugly thouâ€¹
- How many have begun this happy practice of Prayer, and Internal Recollection, and have left it off, pretending that they feel no pleasure, â€¹

Miguel de Unamuno

- If you look at the universe as closely and as inwardly as you are able to lookâ€¹that is to say, if you look within yourself; if you not onlyâ€¹
- Although this meditation upon mortality may soon induce in us a sense of anguish, it fortifies us in the end. Retire, reader, into yourselfâ€¹
- Miguel de Molinos, who said in his Guia Espiritual 1 that 'he who would attain to the mystical science must abandon and be detached from fiâ€¹
- He who sees God shall die, say the Scriptures (Judg. xiii. 22); and may it not be that the eternal vision of God is an eternal death, a swoâ€¹
- But there is another more intimate union, and this is " like rain falling from heaven into a river or stream, becoming one and the same liqâ€¹
- A beatific vision, a loving contemplation in which the soul is absorbed in God and, as it were, lost in Him, appears either as an annihilatâ€¹

Nietzsche

- Christianity as Antiquity.â€¹When on a Sunday morning we hear the old bells ringing, we ask ourselves: Is it possible? All this for a Jew cruâ€¹
- The two physiological facts upon which it grounds itself and upon which it bestows its chief attention are: first, an excessive sensitiveneâ€¹
- The life of the Saviour was simply a carrying out of this way of life--and so was his death. . . He no longer needed any formula or ritual â€¹

- Consequently the value of life for the generality of mankind consists simply in the fact that the individual attaches more importance to his
- prayer and forgiveness
- interpretation? Or did he expand upon it? Or did he simply "clarify" the message?) "The life of the Saviour was simply a carrying out of "

Pascal

- Let him see therein an infinity of universes, each of which has its firmament, its planets, its earth, in the same proportion as in the visible
- Through failure to contemplate these Infinities, men have rashly rushed into the examination of nature, as though they bore some proportion
- ...I have discovered that all the unhappiness of men arises from one single fact, that they cannot stay quietly in their own chamber. A man
- When I consider the short duration of my life, swallowed up in the eternity before and after, the little space which I fill, and even can see
- is something that goes almost utterly unexpressed by the new atheists and our current culture) "I find it necessary to point out the sinful"

Paul Tillich

- In order to go into it, man must empty himself of all the finite contents of his ordinary life; he must surrender all preliminary concerns
- Without some participation in the object of one's ultimate concern, it is not possible to be concerned about it. In this sense every act of
- The danger of this method, of course, is that the faith, meditated in education, will remain a traditional attitude and never break through
- (participation! Turning inward, contemplation, meditation, solitude)
- s ultimate concern, it is not possible to be concerned about it. In this sense every act of faith presupposes participation in that toward

Peter Zappfe

- In everyday interaction, isolation is manifested in a general code of mutual silence: primarily toward children, so these are not at once seen

Plato /Socrates

- And is there anything surprising in one who passes from divine contemplations to the evil state of man, misbehaving himself in a ridiculous

St. John of the Cross

- The teaching set before us here then is, that the faith, which is obscure night, illumines the soul which is in darkness, according to the â€
- the intellect cannot be immediately directed in the way of God by any knowledge such as this, and that, if it is to draw near unto God, it â€
- How sad it is to see men who, when the soul would be at peace in the repose of interior quiet, where God fills it with refreshment and peaceâ€
- To these my counsel isâ€” learn to abide with attention in loving waiting upon God in the state of quiet; give no heed to your imagination, nâ€
- This is the first and principal benefit caused by this arid and dark night of contemplation: the knowledge of oneself and of oneâ€™s misery.
- It is that, in this dark night of the desire (to the end that the words of the Prophet may be fulfilled, namely: â€Thy light shall shine in â€

Swami Vivekananda

- You will be astonished to hear that they have no churches, no Common Prayers, or anything of the kind; but they, every day, still practice â€
- A disciple went to his master and said to him, "Sir, I want religion." The master looked at the young man, and did not speak, but only smiledâ€
- s name, like Darwin or Huxley, is cited, we follow blindly. It is the fashion of the day...True science asks us to be cautious. Just as we â€
- , as Vivekananda defines him, that does not realize the truths of religion) â€œWho wants God? That is the question. Do you think that all thiâ€

Theresa of Avila

- At other times I find myself so arid that I am not able to form any distinct idea of God, nor can I put my soul into an attitude of prayer,â€
- Prayer.â€”In prayer there would sometimes come upon me such a sense of the Presence of God that I seemed to be all engulfed in God. I think tâ€
- Now this is the difference between natural and supernatural prayer: between mental and transcendental prayer. In ordinary prayer we more orâ€
- At the same time, as a far-off means of attaining to supernatural prayer, it is necessary to put upon ourselves the acquiring of the great â€
- And now I return most humbly to beseech your Reverence, that, if you mean to impart to any one these things that you have made me write conâ€
- Progress has nothing to do with enjoying the greatest number of consolations in prayer, or with raptures, visions or favours often given byâ€

Therese of Lisieux

- I have obtained many spiritual lights through the works of St. John of the Cross. When I was seventeen and eighteen they were my only food;â€

- One morning, in my duty as sacristan, I came to put back the keys of the Communion-grating. This was my work, and I was very pleased to have it.
- So experience showed me that the sole happiness of earth consists in lying hidden, and remaining in total ignorance of created things. I said:
- As I meditated on these Divine words, I saw how imperfect was the love I bore my Sisters in religion. I understood that I did not love them.
- Ah! What attracted me was Jesus hidden in the depths of her soul--Jesus who maketh sweet even that which is most bitter. (Vivekananda- see)
- defects--not being surprised at their weakness, but edified at their smallest virtues. -
"If we are asked pleasantly, it is easy to give; if

Thomas Aquinas

- -"I can write no more. I have seen things that make my writings like straw." On his infused contemplation.

Thomas Keating

- Contemplative prayer begins to make us aware of the divine presence within us, the source of true happiness. As soon as we begin to taste it.
- Everybody is culturally conditioned to some degree. Even the greatest saints only reach a certain degree of freedom from cultural over-identification.

Thomas Kempis

- O how many and grievous tribulations did the Apostles, Martyrs, Confessors, Virgins, endure; and all others who would walk in the footsteps!
- ...do many things displease thee and often trouble thee, that thou art not yet perfectly dead to thyself nor separated from all earthly things!
- I desire no consolation which taketh away from me compunction, I love no contemplation which leadeth to pride.
- It is no small prudence to keep silence in an evil time and to turn inwardly unto Me, and not to be troubled by human judgment.
- Many are found who desire contemplation, but they do not strive to practice those things which are required thereunto. It is also a great sin.
- As long as thou livest thou art subject to change, howsoever unwilling; so that thou art found now joyful, now sad; now at peace, now disquiet.

Thomas Merton

- A contemplative is not one who takes his prayer seriously, but one who takes God seriously, who is famished for truth, who seeks to live in it.
- This is a grace which, though quite normal in the spiritual life, is not shared by all. But even those who do not have this particular attraction

- In order to meditate, I have to withdraw my mind from all that prevents me from attending to God present in my heart. This is impossible unâ€
- Habitual self-complacency is almost always a sign of spiritual stagnation. The complacent no longer feel in themselves any real indigence, â€
- It is usually better to remain quiet, to be still. But there is no reason why one should not also meditate walking up and down in a garden.â€
- Compunction is simply an awareness of our indigence and coldness and of our need for God. It implies faith, sorrow, humility and above all â€

Tolstoy

- â€œIt is in vain that we fly from danger, and guard our material life by all imaginable means; in spite of all, death is before us, if not inâ€

William James

- s Other, not good. Which is why Augustine says that Evil is negative in existence since evil is simply a lack of goodness. â€œLet us see rathâ€

William Lane Craig-

- Thus they yelled and laughed. Then, writes Nietzsche, the madman turned in their midst and pierced them with his eyes 'Whither is God?' he â€
- I shall tell you. We have killed himâ€”you and I. All of us are his murderers. But how have we done this? How were we able to drink up the seâ€

Detachment/Renunciation

Aldous Huxley

- , Bertrand Russell

Augustine

- For there is an attractiveness in beautiful bodies, in gold and silver, and all things; and in bodily touch, sympathy hath much influence, â€
- Wherefore delay then to abandon worldly hopes, and give ourselves wholly to seek after God and the blessed life? But wait! Even those thingâ€

Emile Cioran

- true solitude is the feeling of being absolutely isolated between the earth and the sky. nothing should detract attention from these phenomâ€
- these states, in which separation from the world steadily and painfully increases, bring man closer to his inner reality and cause him to dâ€

- melancholy detachment removes man from his natural surroundings. his outlook on infinity shows him to be lonely and forsaken. the sharper oâ€
- s interest. then revelations about the world spring from the deepest corner of the spirit, from the place where it has detached itself fromâ€
- s immanence in life occurs during illnesses and long depressive states. there are, of course, other ways, but they are accidental and indivâ€
- t it related to the feeling of interior and exterior infinity?â€œ â€œmelancholy detachment removes man from his natural surroundings. his outloâ€

Evelyn Underhill

- Here East and West are in agreement: "Their science," says Al Ghazzali of the Sufis, who practised, like the early Franciscans, a complete â€
- The theory here advanced that the "Dark Night" is, on its psychic side, partly a condition of fatigue, partly a state of transition, is borâ€
- and their friends forsake them; their intellectual life is at a low ebb. In their own words
- s spirit for that union with God to which it aspires. She strips off the clothing which he so often mistakes for himself, transvaluates allâ€

Jesus

- Go and sell what you have and give it to the poor, and you shall have treasure in heaven; and come and follow me.
- Do not lay up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust destroy and where thieves break in and steal, but lay up for yourselfeâ€
- Sell that ye have, and give alms; provide yourselves bags which wax not old, a treasure in the heavens that faileth not, where no thief appâ€

John Bunyan

- One morning as I lay in my bed, I was, as at other times, most fiercely assaulted with this temptation to sell and part with Christ, the wiâ€

Kierkegaard

- The active one will do all for the Good, the sufferer will suffer all for the Good (karma/jnana). The similarity is that they both may be aâ€
- or that he is to be respected as a person, to all appearance he is to be regarded as a person. In Christendom he is a Christian (quite in tâ€
- s use of Cleverness- â€œBut the sufferer who sincerely wills the Good, uses this very cleverness to cut off evasions and hence to launch himsâ€

Miguel de Molinos

- It is not enough for gaining this Treasure, to forsake the World, nor to renounce thine own Desires, and all things created; if thou wean nâ€™!

Miguel de Unamuno

- Miguel de Molinos, who said in his Guia Espiritual 1 that 'he who would attain to the mystical science must abandon and be detached from fiâ€™!
- And this is truth. For in his head the righteous man may say to himself, God does not exist! But only the wicked can say it in his heart. Nâ€™!

Plato /Socrates

- ...the entire soul is pierced and maddened and pained, and at the recollection of beauty is again delighted. And from both of them togetherâ€™!

St. John of the Cross

- This journey or ascent must therefore be a perpetual struggle with our desires to make them cease, and the more earnest we are the sooner sâ€™!
- This God himself will do during the observance of the first two commandments; He will change them from old into new, by infusing into the sâ€™!
- And because no creature can, by any actions or capabilities of its own, attain to that which is God, the soul must be therefore detached frâ€™!
- This burden is the cross. For if we are determined to submit ourselves, and to carry the crossâ€™" this is nothing else but an earnest resolutâ€™!

Swami Vivekananda

- The first test of love is that it knows no bargaining. So long as you see a man love another only to get something from him, you know that â€™!
- , as Vivekananda defines him, that does not realize the truths of religion) â€™œWho wants God? That is the question. Do you think that all thiâ€™!

Theresa of Avila

- ...it remains for us to become detached from our own selves and it is a hard thing to withdraw from ourselves and oppose ourselves, becauseâ€™!
- I do not mean, by "leaving" everything, entering the religious life, for there may be obstacles to this, and the soul that is perfect can bâ€™!

Thomas Kempis

- The kingdom of God is within you,(1) saith the Lord. Turn thee with all thine heart to the Lord and forsake this miserable world, and thou â€™!

Timothy Leary

- Everything that exists outside your body and your shrine belongs to Caesar. Caesar has constructed the fake-prop studio for his "king-of -tâ€'

Tolstoy

- Our masters tell us that there are only two ways,â€”to believe in and obey the powers that be, to participate in the organized evil about us,â€'
- â€œIt is in vain that we fly from danger, and guard our material life by all imaginable means; in spite of all, death is before us, if not inâ€'
- s soul for the future life.â€• â€œOur masters tell us that there are only two ways,â€”to believe in and obey the powers that be, to participate iâ€'

William James

- Accordingly, throughout the annals of the saintly life, we find this ever-recurring note: Fling yourself upon God's providence without makiâ€'

William Lane Craig-

- Men did not yet truly comprehend the consequences of what they had done in killing God. But Nietzsche predicted that someday people would râ€'
- And this is just fooling ourselves. The point is this: if God does not exist, then life is objectively meaningless; but man cannot live conâ€'
- I shall tell you. We have killed himâ€”you and I. All of us are his murderers. But how have we done this? How were we able to drink up the seâ€'
- s pretend the universe has meaning." And this is just fooling ourselves. The point is this: if God does not exist, then life is objectivelyâ€'

Suffering/Martyrdom

A. W. Tozer

- The way to deeper knowledge of God is through the lonely valleys of soul poverty and abnegation of all things. The blessed ones who possessâ€'
- The world is perishing for lack of the knowledge of God and the Church is famishing for want of His Presence. The instant cure of most of oâ€'
- s gifts now take the place of God, and the whole course of nature is upset by the monstrous substitution.â€• â€œ...it would seem that there is â€'

Aldous Huxley

- Of those who die an infinitesimal minority are capable of immediate union with the divine Ground, a few are capable of supporting the visioâ€'

- The righteous man can escape suffering only by accepting it and passing beyond it...by being converted from righteousness to total selflessness!
- Probably all persons, even the most saintly, suffer to some extent from distractions...make use of distractions.
- his book, Raymond; but there is also a heaven of blissful visionary experience; there is also a hell of the same kind of appalling visionary!
- "the formula is absurdly simple; and yet, simple as it is, it explains all the follies and iniquities committed in the name of religion."
- vain repetition...to use the name of God to justify what they do in pursuit of place, power and wealth." "The moralists cease to be realistic!"

Bertrand Russell

- In the spectacle of Death, in the endurance of intolerable pain, and in the irrevocableness of a vanished past, there is a sacredness, an oath!

Edgar Saltus

- His logic reduced itself to the paraphrase of an axiom, "I am, therefore I suffer," and the suffering which he experienced was not, he was!
- There are those, too, who from dyspepsia, torpidity of the liver, or general crankiness of disposition, are inclined to take a gloomy view!
- On a higher level is he who, possessing a considerable income, uses but little of it for himself and gives the rest to the poor, the man who!
- I am, therefore I suffer,
- there is also a haphazard pessimism which comes of an unevenness of disposition, and which asserts itself on a rainy day, or when stocks are!
- his philosophers) "They are merely the resultants of the obvious and the true; they leap into being in every intelligent mind." (me- recollected!

Emile Cioran

- the experience of suffering is a similar case. you never suspected what lay hidden in yourself and in the world, you were living contentedly!
- how distant everything is! i don't understand why we must do things in this world, why we must have friends and aspirations, hopes and dreams!
- i call agonizing only those dramatic moments in the battle between life and death when the presence of death is experienced consciously and painfully!
- only those who truly suffer are capable of genuine content and infinite seriousness...there are many who would gladly give up metaphysics!
- yet other philosophies and doctrines say almost nothing about death. the only valid attitude is absolute silence or a cry of despair. some!

- the art of dying cannot be learned, because there is no technique, there are no rules. the irrevocability of agony is experienced by each iâ€

Ernest Becker

- And then the real tragedy, as Andre Malraux wrote in The Human Condition: that it takes sixty years of incredible suffering and effort to mâ€
- â€© (is this why the experience of Meaninglessness is stronger/more important the the Mystical experience, with Tillich, Vivekananda, Cioran,â€
- , i.e. the arbitrary nature of pursuing one thing over the other, enjoying one thing over another, the idea of wanting this over that, the â€

Evelyn Underhill

- In the great moments of existence, when he rises to spiritual freedom, these are the things which every man feels to be real. It is by thesâ€
- The question is not, whence come those conditions which provoke in the self the experiences called sorrow, anxiety, pain: but, why do theseâ€
- He calls suffering the â€œgymnastic of eternity,
- To the true lover of the Absolute, Purgation no less than Illumination is a privilege, a dreadful joy. It is an earnest of increasing life.â€
- Since the greater and stronger the mystic, the stronger and more stubborn his character tends to be, this change of life and turning of eneâ€
- In this intermittent style, torn by these constant fluctuations between depression and delight, did Merswin, in whom the psychic instabilitâ€

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- Why do men learn through pain and suffering, and not through pleasure and happiness? Very simply, because pleasure and happiness accustom oâ€
- s is a "Nihilism" that proceeds from abundance. The true Nihilist places his faith in things that pass away and end in nothing; all "optimiâ€

Herman TÃ, nnessen

- ...cognitive...empathetic 'disintegrity'...to hold cognitively incompatible views or positions...to prevent knowledge from penetrating 'volâ€

Kierkegaard

- ...man is invited to live on the most intimate terms with God! Furthermore, for this manâ€™s sake God came to the world, let himself be born,â€
- So he despairs. His despair is that of weakness, a passive suffering of the self, in contrast to the despair of self-assertion; but, by theâ€

- Oh, you sufferer, whoever you may be, will you then with doubleness of mind seek the relief that temporal existence can give, the relief that
- But here on earth, Good is often temporarily rewarded by ingratitude, by lack of appreciation, by poverty, by contempt, by many sufferings,
- For the wish is the sufferer's connection with a happier temporal existence (faith and hope are related to the Eternal through the will);
- Yet sad as it is with the wish, how joyful it is with hope! For there is a hope that is born and dies; a short-lived hope, that tomorrow is

Lev Shestov

- Ordinary free-thinkers would not have endured for a single day Nietzsche's trials, which he calls his "fortune." In his situation, they would
- The discipline of suffering, of great suffering - do you not know that it is only this discipline that has created all the elevations of man
- From my early youth," says Kierkegaard, "I have lived a perpetual contradiction: to others I appear uncommonly gifted, but in the depths of
- He notes in his journal: "Only horror that has turned to despair can develop a man's higher powers." Journal, II, 204 "Quite a few men have
- Is not such a celebration of the "ethical," in Kierkegaard's work as well as Nietzsche's, simply an expression of profound, irreconcilable,
- All Kierkegaard's edifying discourses and he wrote an immense number of them are one continual fiery, unrestrained, ecstatic hymn to horror

Martin Luther

- The more Christian a man is, the more evils, sufferings, and deaths he must endure...
- This is the highest degree of faith to believe that He is merciful, who saves so few and damns so many; to believe Him just, who according
-) Works are not condemned, but devalued because they are Earthly. The only thing that matters is not of this earth, is not of this Kingdom,
- to delight in the torments of the miserable, and to be an object of hatred rather than of love.

Meister Eckhart

- The quickest means to bring us to perfection is suffering; none enjoy everlasting blessedness more than those who share with Christ the bitter
- s good works and prayers, as though they had accomplished none, and He is by those means no more favourably inclined towards men than if that

Miguel de Molinos

- Many Souls when they suffer these painful torments, are troubled, afflicted, and disquieted, it seeming to them, that they begin already inâ€
- God loves not him who does most, who hears most, nor who shows greatest affection, but who suffers most, if he pray with faith and reverencâ€
- The Senses are not capable of divine Blessings; hence if thou would be Happy and Wise; be Silent and Believe; Suffer and have Patience; be â€
- Our own nature is so base, proud and ambitious, and so full of its own appetites, its own judgements and opinions, that if temptations restâ€
- In the time of the recollection, Peace and Resignation of thy Soul, God will more esteem the various impertinent, troublesome and ugly thouâ€
- How many have begun this happy practice of Prayer, and Internal Recollection, and have left it off, pretending that they feel no pleasure, â€

Miguel de Unamuno

- All this talk of a man surviving in his children, or in his works, or in the universal consciousness, is but vague verbiage which satisfiesâ€
- For all consciousness is consciousness of death and of suffering.
- We personalize the All in order to save ourselves from Nothingness; and the only mystery really mysterious is the mystery of suffering. Sufâ€
- And how do we know that we exist if we do not suffer, little or much? How can we turn upon ourselves, acquire reflective consciousness, savâ€
- And God is simply the Love that springs from universal suffering and becomes consciousness.
- We ought to ask God to make us conscious of ourselves in ourselves, in our suffering.

Nietzsche

- Suffering it was, and impotence - that created all afterworlds; and the brief madness of bliss, which is experienced only by those who suffâ€
- an imaginary teleology (the "kingdom of God," "the last judgment," "eternal life").--This purely fictitious world, greatly to its disadvantâ€
- I allude to Buddhism. Both are to be reckoned among the nihilistic religions--they are both decadence religions--but they are separated froâ€
- ...when faith is thus exalted above everything else, it necessarily follows that reason, knowledge and patient inquiry have to be discreditâ€
- What the Gospels make instinctive is precisely the reverse of all heroic struggle, of all taste for conflict: the very incapacity for resisâ€
- This "bearer of glad tidings" died as he lived and taught--not to "save mankind," but to show mankind how to live. It was a way of life thaâ€

Pascal

- Nothing is so insufferable to man as to be completely at rest, without passions, without business, without diversion, without study. He theâ€¦!
- He who does not see the vanity of the world is himself very vain. Indeed who do not see it but youths who are absorbed in fame, diversion, â€¦!
- Nothing is so important to man as his own state, nothing is so formidable to him as eternity; and thus it is not natural that there should â€¦!
- religious experience) â€œHe who does not see the vanity of the world is himself very vain. Indeed who do not see it but youths who are absorbâ€¦!
- in a symbolic, non-literal sense) -â€œNothing is so important to man as his own state, nothing is so formidable to him as eternity; and thus â€¦!

Paul Tillich

- Spiritual creativity shows an increasingly shallow and empty character, because no infinite meaning gives depth to it. The passion of faithâ€¦!

Plato /Socrates

- And now look again, and see what will naturally follow if the prisoners are released and disabused of their error. At first, when any of thâ€¦!

Schopenhauer

- ...the misery of boredom...boredom is a form of suffering unknown to brutes.
- s booth at a fair, and witnesses the performance twice or thrice in succession. The tricks were meant to be seen only once; and when they aâ€¦!

St. John of the Cross

- ...giving themselves up to suffer for Christ's sake, and annihilating themselves utterly. He who shall exercise himself herein, will then fâ€¦!
- ...I see that Jesus Christ is but little known by those who consider themselves His friends. These, loving themselves very much, seek in Hiâ€¦!
- they have lost their love of the things of the world and have gained some degree of spiritual strength in God; this has enabled them to somâ€¦!
- The fourth kind of pain is caused in the soul by another excellence of this dark contemplation, which is its majesty and greatness, from whâ€¦!
- All this God brings to pass by means of this dark contemplation; wherein the soul not only suffers this emptiness and the suspension of theâ€¦!
- Herein is described the grave suffering which the soul here endures in the purgation of the fire of this contemplation, for the Prophet sayâ€¦!

Theresa of Avila

- For it must never be thought that because a man has much suffering, therefore he cannot have prayed acceptably. His suffering is as incense!'
- What sufferings they bore, what solitude, cold, thirst and hunger, what burning sun and heat! And yet they had no one to complain to except!'
- A discontented soul is like a person suffering from severe nausea, who rejects all food, however nice it may be; things which persons in good health would not touch!'
- anyone who would be perfect, must flee a thousand leagues from such phrases as: "I had right on my side"; "They had no right to do this to me!'
- ...if she does not wish to suffer a hell on earth, and God grant there may not be another hell awaiting such a nun in the world to come.
- "Most happy she who suffers most if it be for Christ!

Therese of Lisieux

- But during the Paschal days, so full of light, our Lord made me understand that there really are in truth souls bereft of Faith and Hope, woe!
- How can it be said that it is more perfect to separate oneself from home and friends? Has anyone ever reproached brothers who fight side by side?
- My heart is naturally sensitive, and because this is a cause of much suffering.
- And I should not suffer any disappointment, for when we expect nothing but suffering, then the least joy is a surprise; and later on suffer!
- ...I knew well that in curbing my natural affection I should have much to suffer.
- Seeing one of our Sisters very much fatigued, I said to Soeur Therese: "It grieves me to see people suffer, especially those who are holy."!

Thomas Keating

- Sometimes a sense of failure is a great means to true humility, which is what God most looks for in us. I realize this is not the language of!'
- Without profound purification, how far can social action actually extend? People involved in social action have a false self, too. They need!'
- This monk chose the way of spiritual discipline to become the Other. There is at least one other way of negotiating the spiral staircase. I!'

Thomas Kempis

- O how many and grievous tribulations did the Apostles, Martyrs, Confessors, Virgins, endure; and all others who would walk in the footsteps!
- Christ was willing to suffer and be despised, and darest thou complain of any?...If thou art unwilling to suffer any adversity, how shalt thou!'
- ...all our peace in this sad life lieth in humble suffering rather than in not feeling adversities.

- The whole life of Christ was a cross and martyrdom, and dost thou seek for thyself rest and joy? Thou art wrong, thou art wrong, if thou seâ€
- "Be zealous against thyself, nor suffer pride to live within thee, but so show thyself subject and of no reputation, that all may be able tâ€

Thomas Ligotti

- Buddhism and pessimism cannot be pried loose from each other. The likeness between them is simply too pronounced to be overlooked. Buddhistâ€
- For the pessimist, everything considered in isolation from human suffering or any cognition that does not have as its motive the origins, nâ€
- Ordinary folk who have nothing to do with supernaturalism and the uncanny and who are resistant to the pessimism of fictions like Invasion â€

Tolstoy

- the whole of this material universe of ours, with all its suns and its milky-ways is nothing." â€œ"The life of the body is evil and a lie, anâ€
- I saw that Jesus did not exhort us to turn the other cheek that we might endure suffering, but that his exhortation was, "Resist not evil,"â€
- In the Sermon on the Mount, as well as in many other places, Jesus represents his disciples, those who observe the rule of non-resistance tâ€
- If he had lived in our day, in Russia, he would have said: "Think you that those who perished in the circus at Berditchef or on the slopes â€
- Perhaps it is right to think that man, after this terrestrial life passed in the satisfaction of personal desires, will enter upon the possâ€
- However surprising the belief that the doctrine of Jesus is excellent, but impossible of practice, there is a still more surprising traditiâ€

William James

- 'We would make known in our own persons the usefulness of rule, of discipline, of resignation and renunciation; we would teach the necessarâ€
- upon everything that can properly be called a thing of this life, even to reckon myself, my wife, my children, my health, my enjoyments, anâ€
- s Other, not good. Which is why Augustine says that Evil is negative in existence since evil is simply a lack of goodness. â€œLet us see rathâ€
- We would make known in our own persons the usefulness of rule, of discipline, of resignation and renunciation; we would teach the necessaryâ€

William Lane Craig-

- s look at each of these. No Ultimate Meaning without Immortality and God If each individual person passes out of existence when he dies, thâ€

Fr. Seraphim Rose

- The whole world, it almost seems, is divided into those who lead meaningless, futile lives without being aware of it, and those who, being aware,

Kierkegaard

- Is not despair simply double-mindedness? For what is despairing other than to have two wills?...whether a man despaired because he got his will,
- or that he is to be respected as a person, to all appearance he is to be regarded as a person. In Christendom he is a Christian (quite in appearance)
- is part of faith, and Kierkegaard said he could never quite make the leap himself, I am not sure this sort of faith can be actualized,

Martin Heidegger

- come up. (this seems to be the reason why most scientists do not understand the consequences of their theories, let alone world-views. The

Miguel de Unamuno

- But there is another more intimate union, and this is "like rain falling from heaven into a river or stream, becoming one and the same liquid"

St. John of the Cross

- It is evident that the faith is a dark night to the soul, and it is thus that it gives it light; the more it darkens the soul the more does it

Therese of Lisieux

- ...I felt that one day I should be set free from this land of darkness. I believed it, not only because I had been told so by others, but mainly
- "No doubt, dear Mother, you will think I exaggerate somewhat the night of my soul. If you judge by the poems I have composed this year, it
- s most secret and deepest longings assured me that there was in store for me another and more beautiful country--an abiding dwelling-place."

William James

- s Other, not good. Which is why Augustine says that Evil is negative in existence since evil is simply a lack of goodness. "Let us see rather"

Apophatic/Silence

Aldous Huxley

- We should talk less and draw more. I personally should like to renounce speech altogether and, like organic Nature, communicate everything â€
- This lowering of what may be called the biological efficiency of the brain seems to permit the entry into consciousness of certain classes â€

Emile Cioran

- yet other philosophies and doctrines say almost nothing about death. the only valid attitude is absolute silence or a cry of despair. some â€
- the feeling of utter confusion! not to be able to differentiate, clarify, understand, or appreciate! such a feeling would make any philosopâ€
- magic is useful for small and inessential things, but powerless when confronted with metaphysical reality, which requires, most of the timeâ€
- why do men insist on achieving something? Would it not be better if they stood still under the sun in calm and silent immobility? what is tâ€
- then you will think it useless to express an opinion, to take a stand, to make an impression; the noises you have renounced increase the anâ€
- To think without being any the wiser, or rather not to think at all but to remain there and to devour the silence â€ that is where perspicacâ€

Evelyn Underhill

- "The soul," he says, "with all its powers, has divided and scattered itself in outward things, each according to its functions: the power oâ€
- Thus Molinos gives in the "Spiritual Guide" many unexceptional maxims upon Interior Silence: "By not speaking nor desiring, and not thinkinâ€
- All activity was forbidden it, all choice was a negation of its surrender, all striving was unnecessary and wrong. It needed only to rest fâ€
- with all its powers, has divided and scattered itself in outward things, each according to its functions: the power of sight in the eye, thâ€
- she arrives at the true and perfect mystical silence wherein God speaks with the soul, communicates Himself to it, and in the abyss of its â€
- let God work and speak in the silence.

Herman TÃnnessen

- ...cognitive...empathetic 'disintegrity'...to hold cognitively incompatible views or positions...to prevent knowledge from penetrating 'volâ€
- t have a dime for the jukebox; the room is painfully satiated with embarrassing silence. Instantly and unexpectedly he is struck by an execâ€

Kierkegaard

- If this introversion is absolutely maintained, omnibus numeris absoluta perfect in every respect, then suicide will be the danger nearest to it!
- And, oh, when the hour-glass has run out, the hourglass of time, when the noise of worldliness is silenced, and the restless or the ineffective!
- ...individual's relation to its historical environment. The most dissimilar things may produce the same effect in this respect. Freedom's path!
- (Tolstoy mentions that his first intuition regarding his existential concerns are that they are commonly referred to as "childish") "On the"
- or that he is to be respected as a person, to all appearance he is to be regarded as a person. In Christendom he is a Christian (quite in itself!
-) "Only too soon personal experience and the experience of others teaches how far most men's lives are from being what a man's life ought to be!"

Lev Shestov

- I repeat, it is an error to think that Nietzsche's experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it occurs perhaps much more often!
- It may be that in a certain sense, i.e., "practically speaking," men are right: but they have not the strength to reduce madness and death to silence.
- Thus Spoke Zarathustra! "I repeat, it is an error to think that Nietzsche's experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it often!"
- men are right: but they have not the strength to reduce madness and death to silence. Madness and death can be driven away temporarily, but not!
- his experience was unique, new, unprecedented. On the contrary, it occurs perhaps much more frequently than is ordinarily assumed. But it is often!
- his mind at rest" can in any sense be applied to Kierkegaard. "Kierkegaard felt the burden of "sin" in everything," but at the same time he also!

Miguel de Molinos

- Think not that when thou art dry and darksome in the presence of God, with faith and silence, that thou do'st nothing, that thou lovest time!"
- Internal Recollection is Faith, and Silence in the Presence of God.
- In the time of the recollection, Peace and Resignation of thy Soul, God will more esteem the various impertinent, troublesome and ugly thou!"
- O how few are the Souls, that attain to this perfect way of Praying, because they penetrate not enough into this internal recollection, and!"
- By not speaking, not desiring, and not thinking, one arrives at the true and perfect Mystical Silence, wherein God speaks with the Soul, continually!
- It is not enough for gaining this Treasure, to forsake the World, nor to renounce thine own Desires, and all things created; if thou wean not!

Miguel de Unamuno

- Although this meditation upon mortality may soon induce in us a sense of anguish, it fortifies us in the end. Retire, reader, into yourself!
- He who sees God shall die, say the Scriptures (Judg. xiii. 22); and may it not be that the eternal vision of God is an eternal death, a swoon?
- But there is another more intimate union, and this is "like rain falling from heaven into a river or stream, becoming one and the same liquid"
- and 'if you do not resist, the senses are not lost, at least I was so much myself as to be able to perceive that I was being lifted up 'as though' "
- And what difference is there between this and the internal and mystical silence of Miguel de Molinos, the third and most perfect degree of " "
- " "that is to say, without losing consciousness. And God

Pascal

- Let him see therein an infinity of universes, each of which has its firmament, its planets, its earth, in the same proportion as in the visible!
- When I consider the short duration of my life, swallowed up in the eternity before and after, the little space which I fill, and even can see!
- is something that goes almost utterly unexpressed by the new atheists and our current culture) "I find it necessary to point out the sinful!"

Peter Zappfe

- In everyday interaction, isolation is manifested in a general code of mutual silence: primarily toward children, so these are not at once seen!

Thomas Kempis

- It is no small prudence to keep silence in an evil time and to turn inwardly unto Me, and not to be troubled by human judgment.
- " "It is often a small thing which casteth me down and maketh me sad. I resolve that I will act bravely, but when a little temptation cometh!"

Thomas Merton

- It is usually better to remain quiet, to be still. But there is no reason why one should not also meditate walking up and down in a garden."

William Lane Craig-

- Thus they yelled and laughed. Then, writes Nietzsche, the madman turned in their midst and pierced them with his eyes 'Whither is God?' he "!"
- I shall tell you. We have killed him" "you and I. All of us are his murderers. But how have we done this? How were we able to drink up the sea?"

Highlight connections

0 connections found

Actions